Idea Space, Sketch and AI where you work

Issue #203 · version 3.11.0 · one pull request for all nine steps. Every picture below is a real screenshot of the running app (a real server and database, the browser driven by Playwright; the AI answers come from a fake provider so that the screens are reproducible).

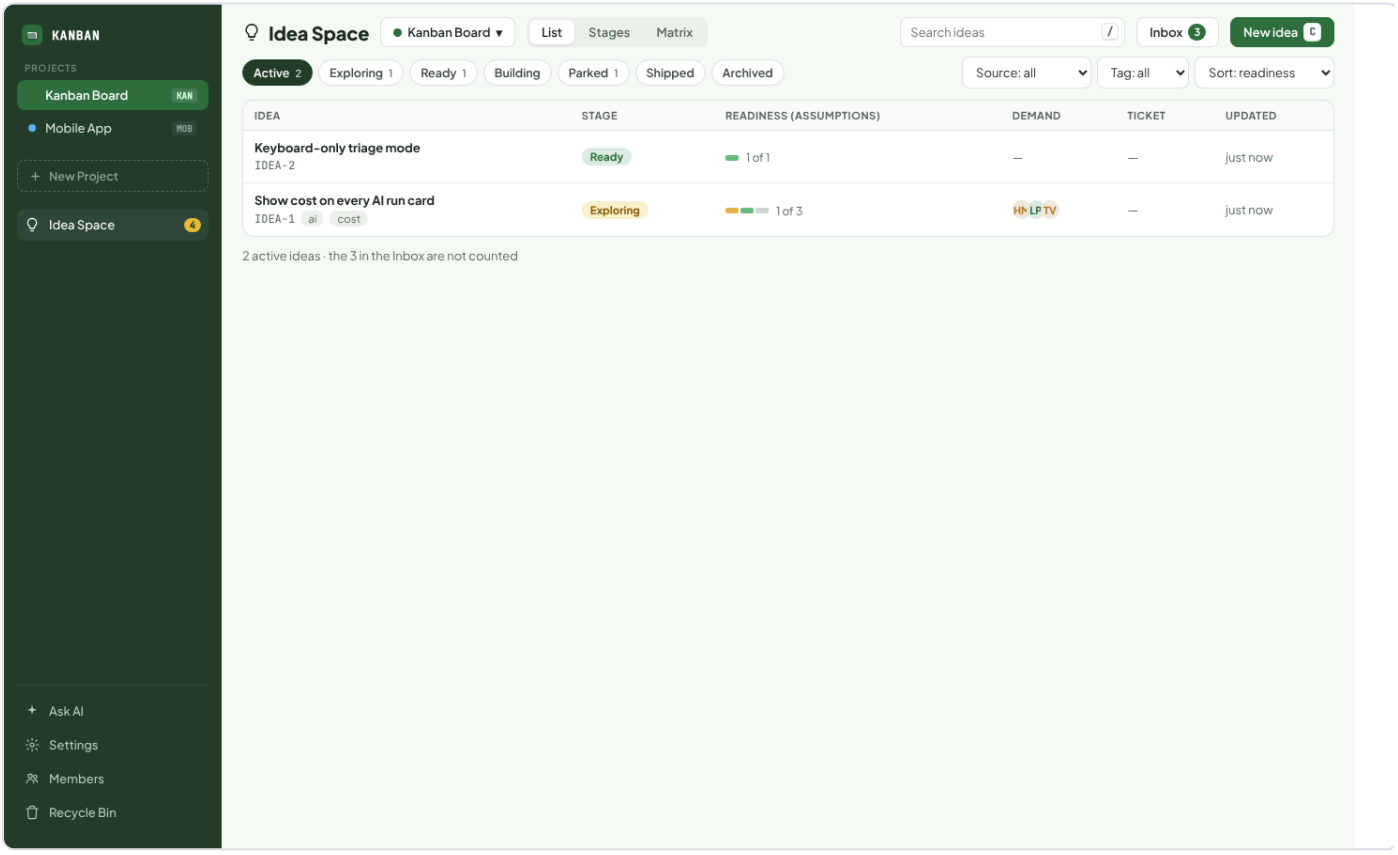
In short. Ideas are now pages with stages, assumptions and evidence, triaged in an Inbox and promoted into tickets. A paint-style **Sketch** tool works in every text and on any picture. AI helpers are on by default but optional (one switch per project), always suggest, never act, and respect the member, budget and safety rules that already exist.

#	STEP	STATE
1	Data model and one-time conversion of existing ideas	Done
2	REST API and MCP tools (AI members can only read and add to the Inbox)	Done
3	Idea Space at workspace level: list, stages, matrix, project switcher	Done
4	Quick add and Inbox triage (Keep, Park, Merge, Archive, undo)	Done
5	The idea page: writing, assumptions, evidence, comments, research log, workspace, activity	Done
6	Promote, and the ticket side (lightbulb, “Started as an idea”, test tickets)	Done
7	Sketch tool (offline, no new dependency)	Done
8	AI where you work: ticket chat, @ in comments, AI in every editor, idea chat	Done
9	AI helpers in the Idea Space: triage advice, Shape, Ask, draft ticket, effort guess, weekly digest	Done

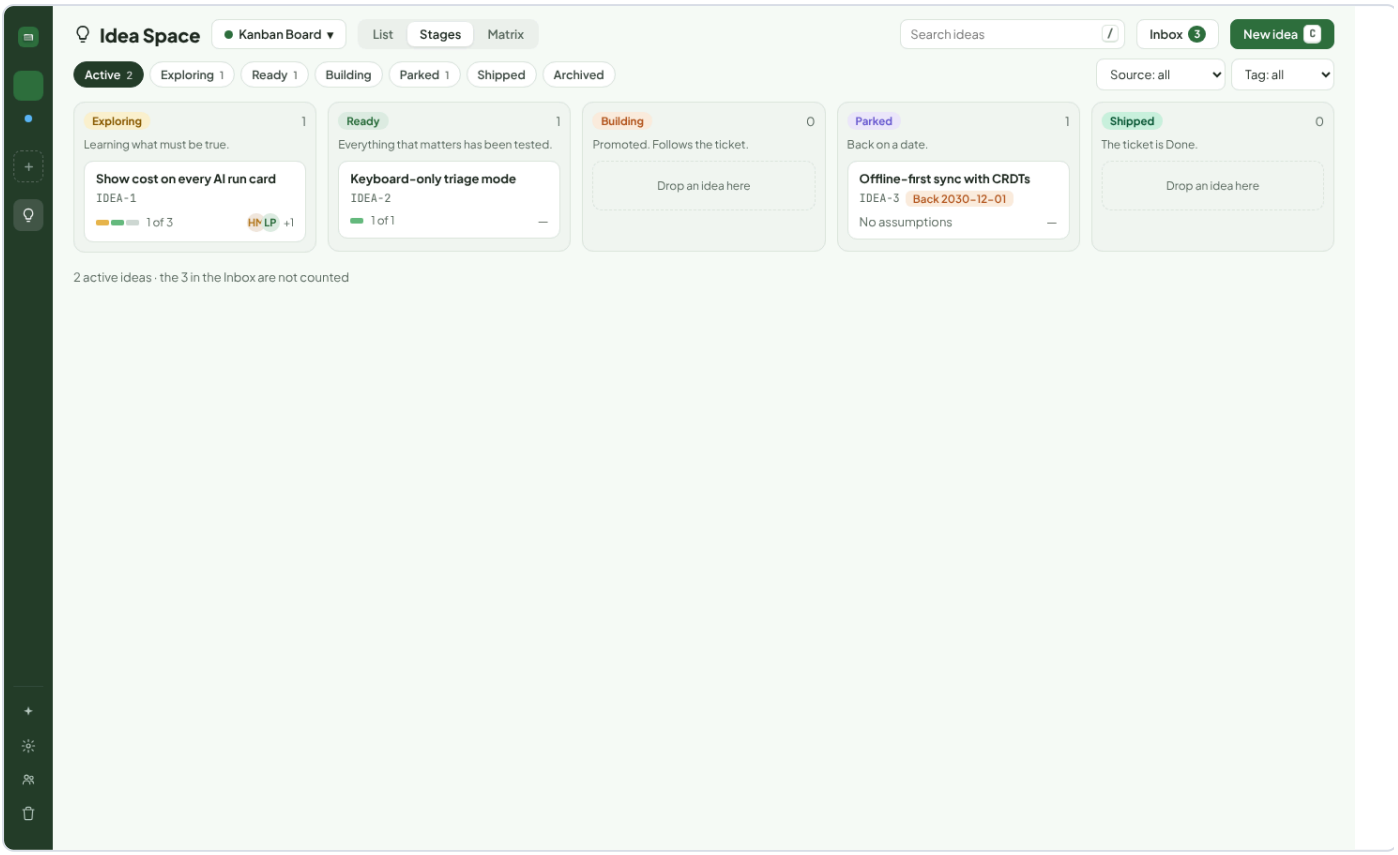
Tests: 857 backend tests pass (pytest), 56 front-end unit tests pass, and type-check, lint, format and build are clean. A list of what is simplified or not built is on the last pages. Specs: `docs/specs/idea-space.md`, `sketch-tool.md`, `ai-where-you-work.md`.

1. The Idea Space: three views

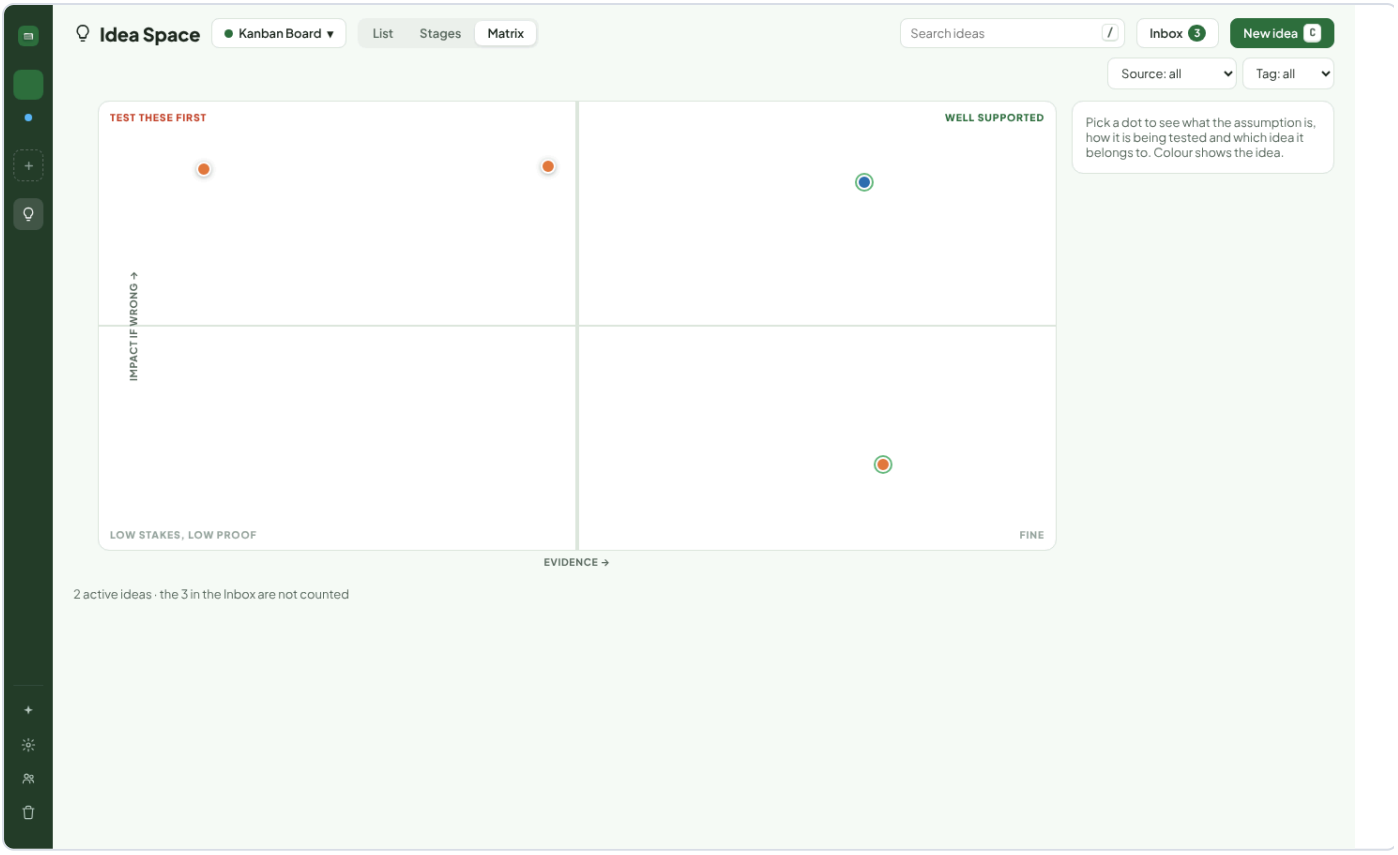
At workspace level, with a project switcher (including ideas that belong to no project). Readiness is worked out from the assumptions, never typed.



List: stage, readiness (only high-impact assumptions decide it), demand, linked ticket.



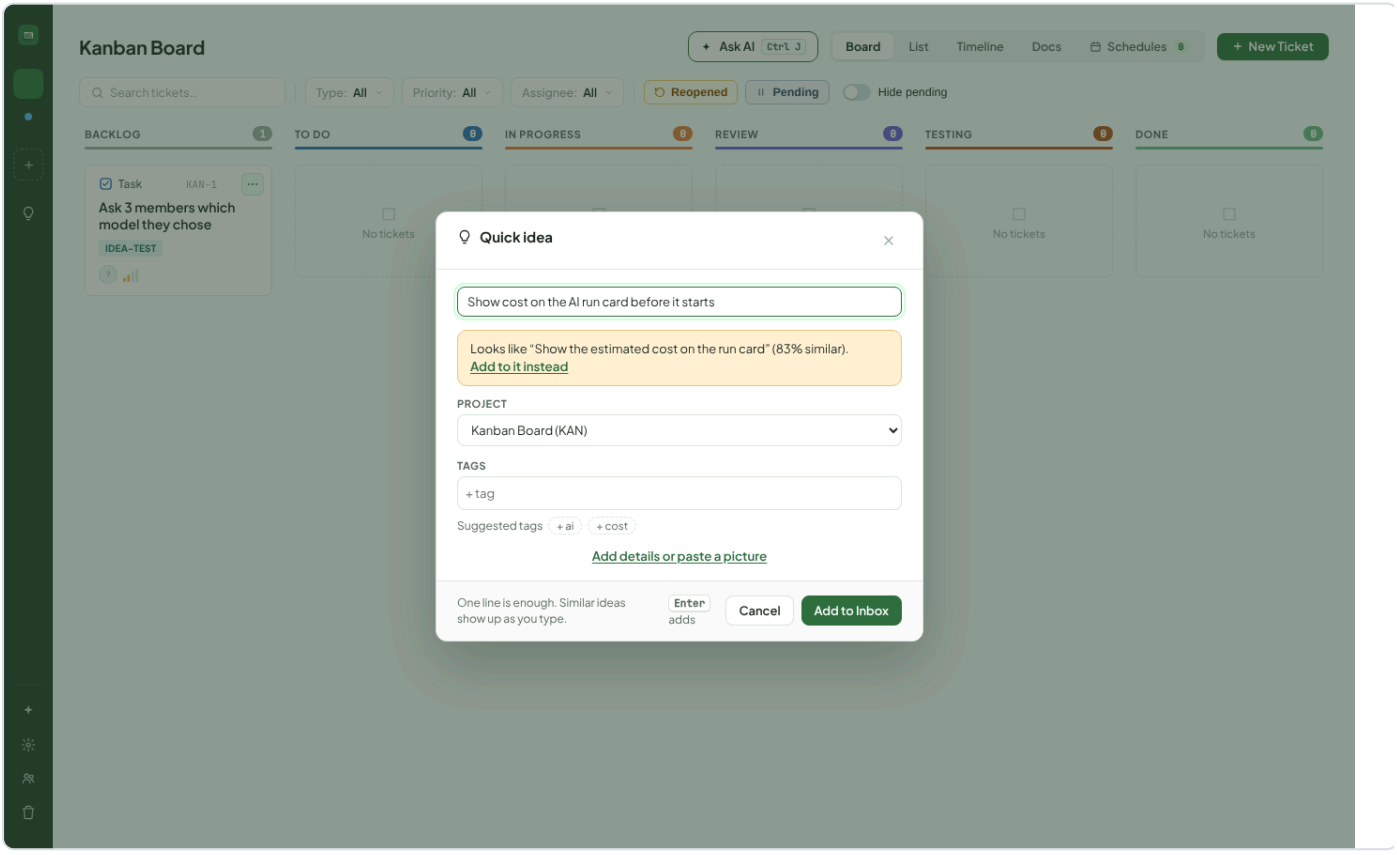
Stages: drag a card to move it. Parking asks for a date; Building cannot be archived.



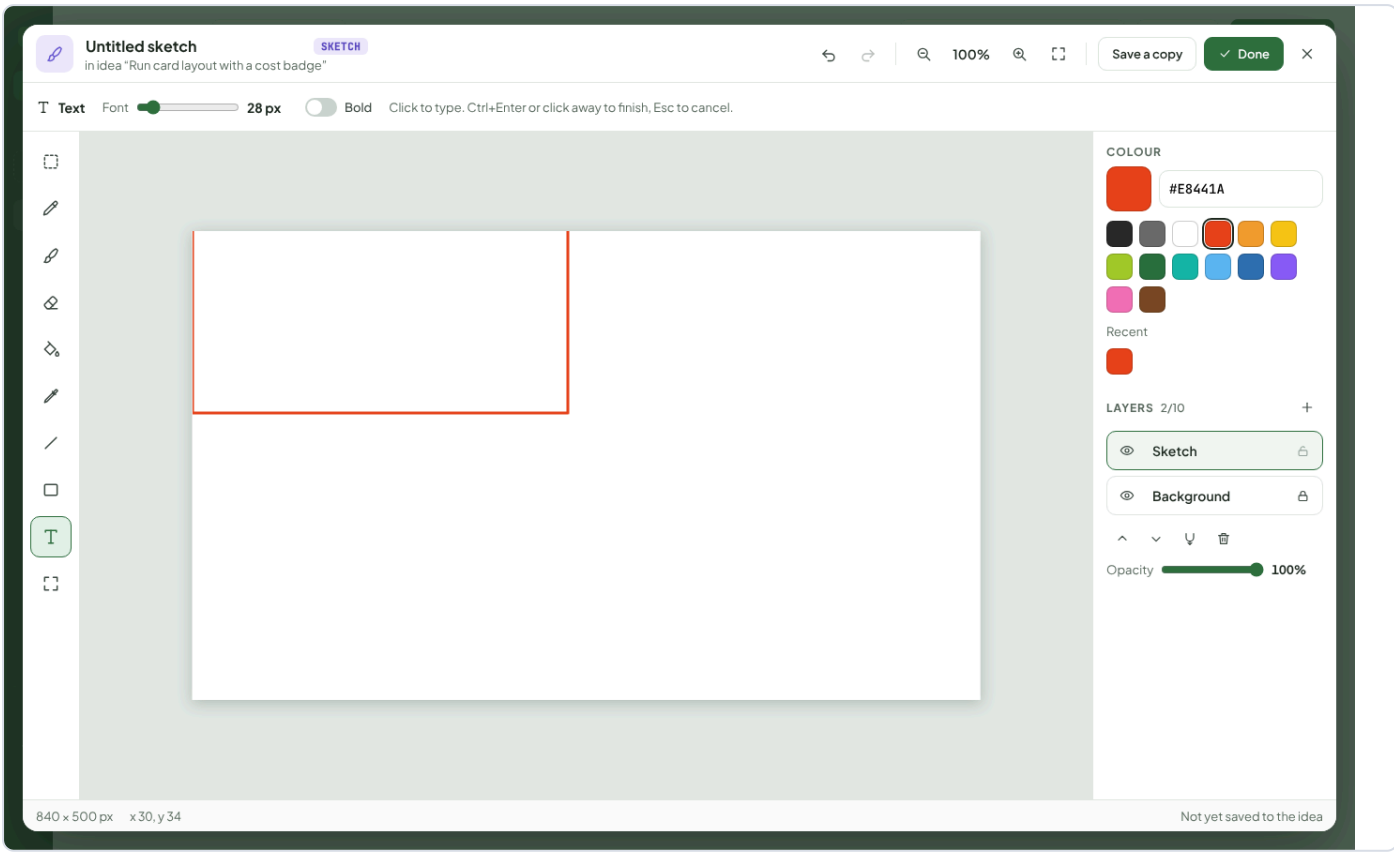
Matrix: impact against strength of evidence, to see what to test first.

2. Quick add and Inbox triage

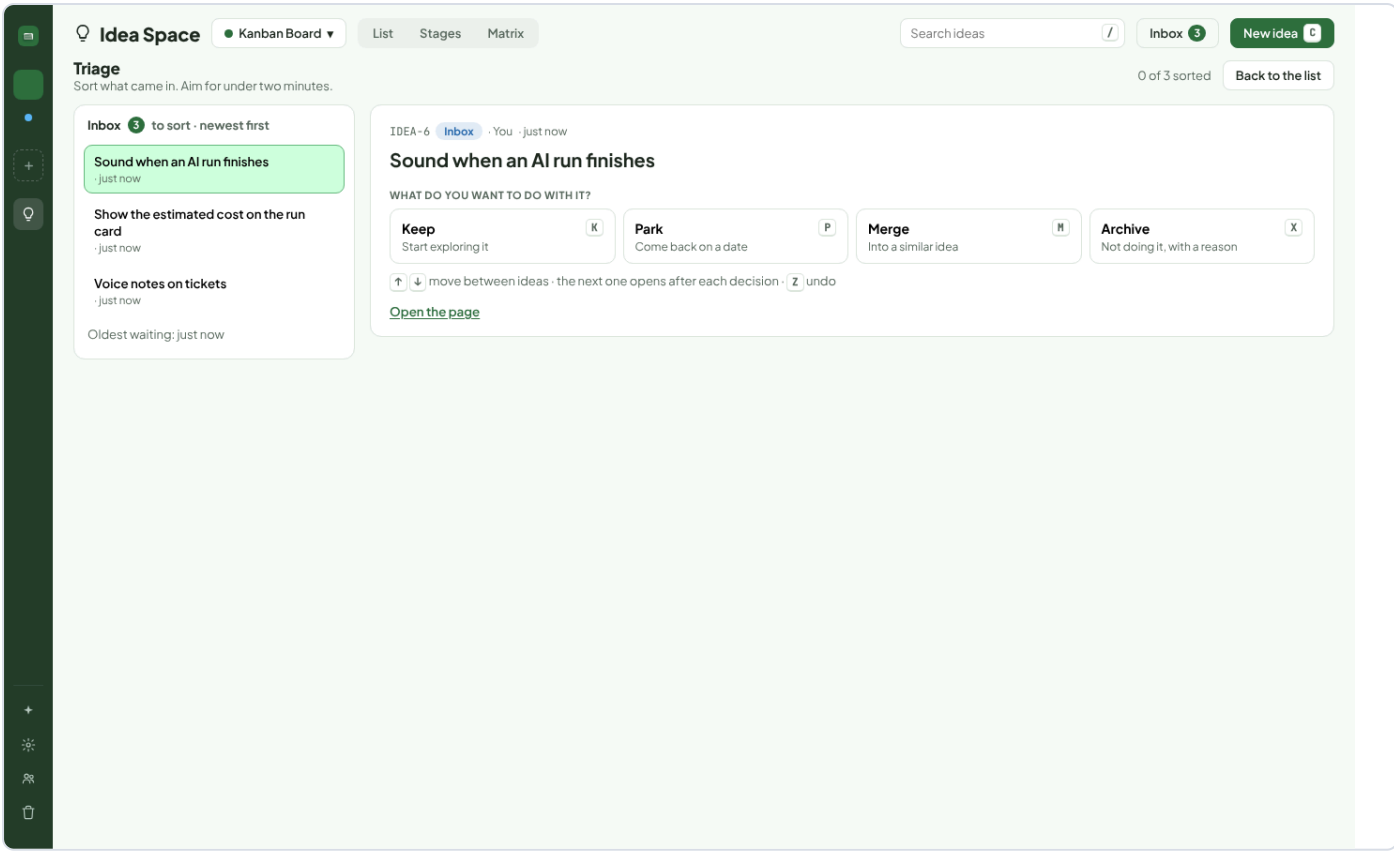
Alt+N from anywhere, or “Make idea” on highlighted text. Every route ends in the Inbox. A local duplicate search (no model) warns while you type.



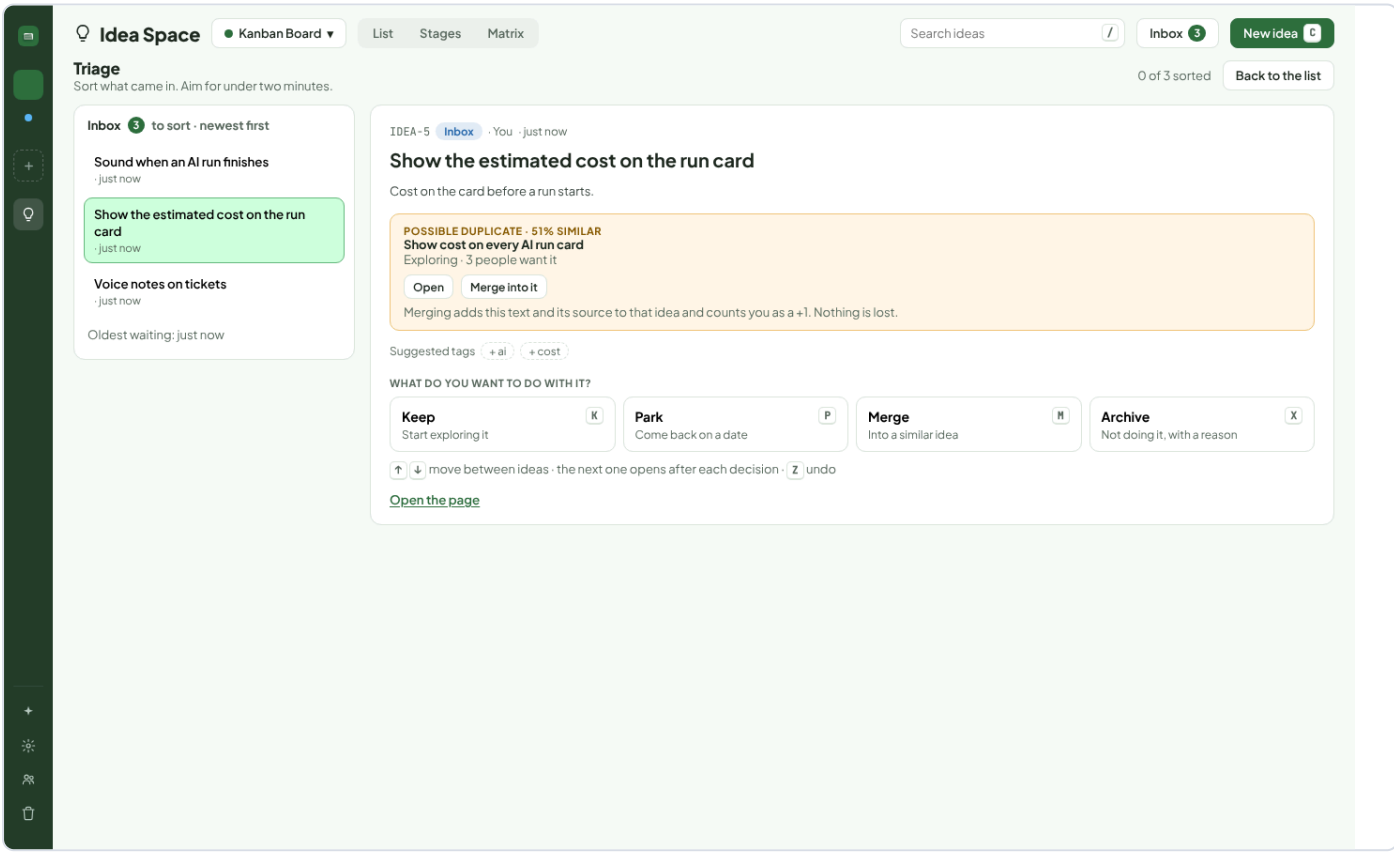
Quick add.



“Start with a sketch” in Quick add opens the Sketch tool; the drawing goes into the new idea’s page.



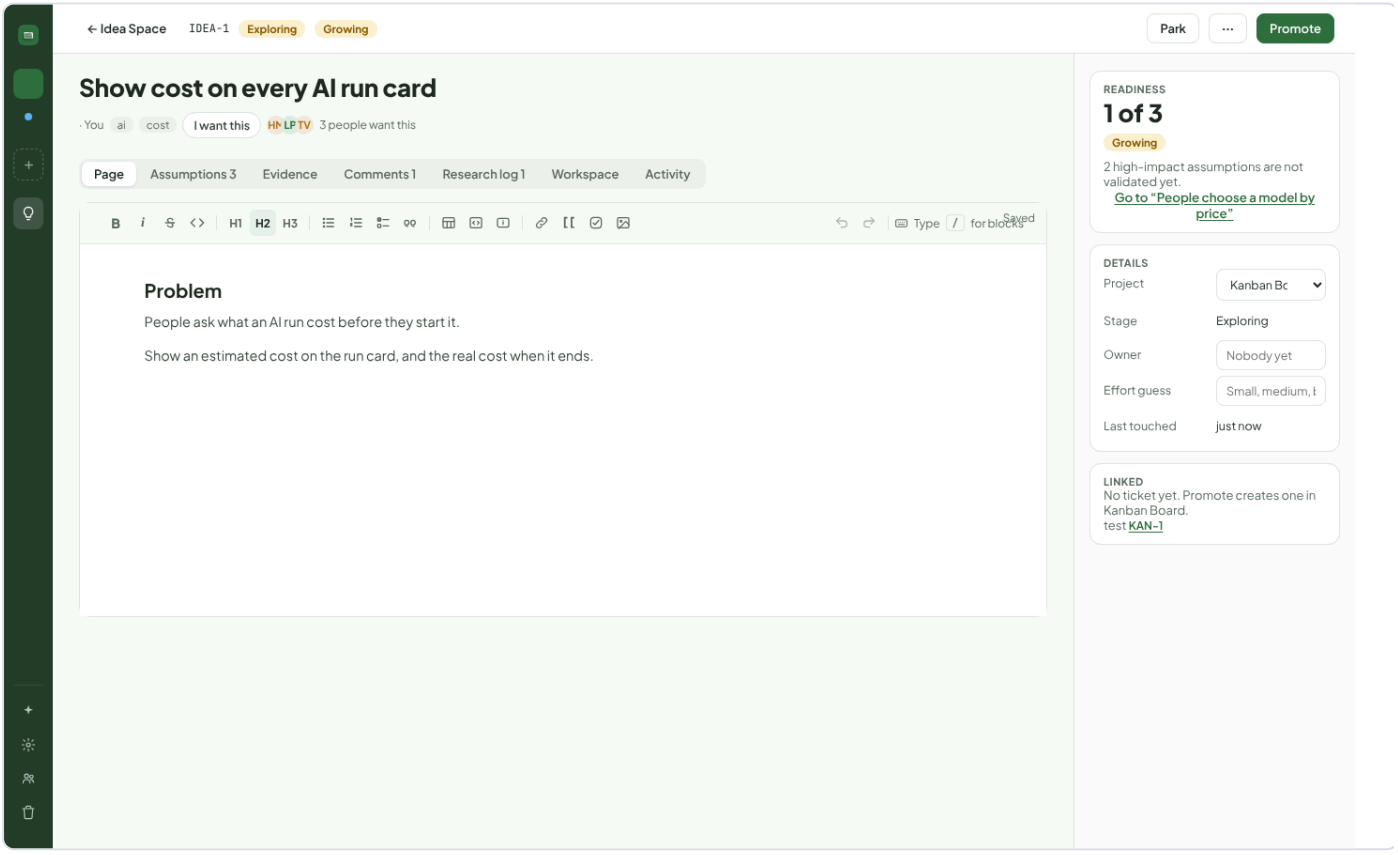
Triage with the keyboard: K keep, P park (needs a date), M merge (undo for 10 minutes), X archive (needs a reason), Z undo.



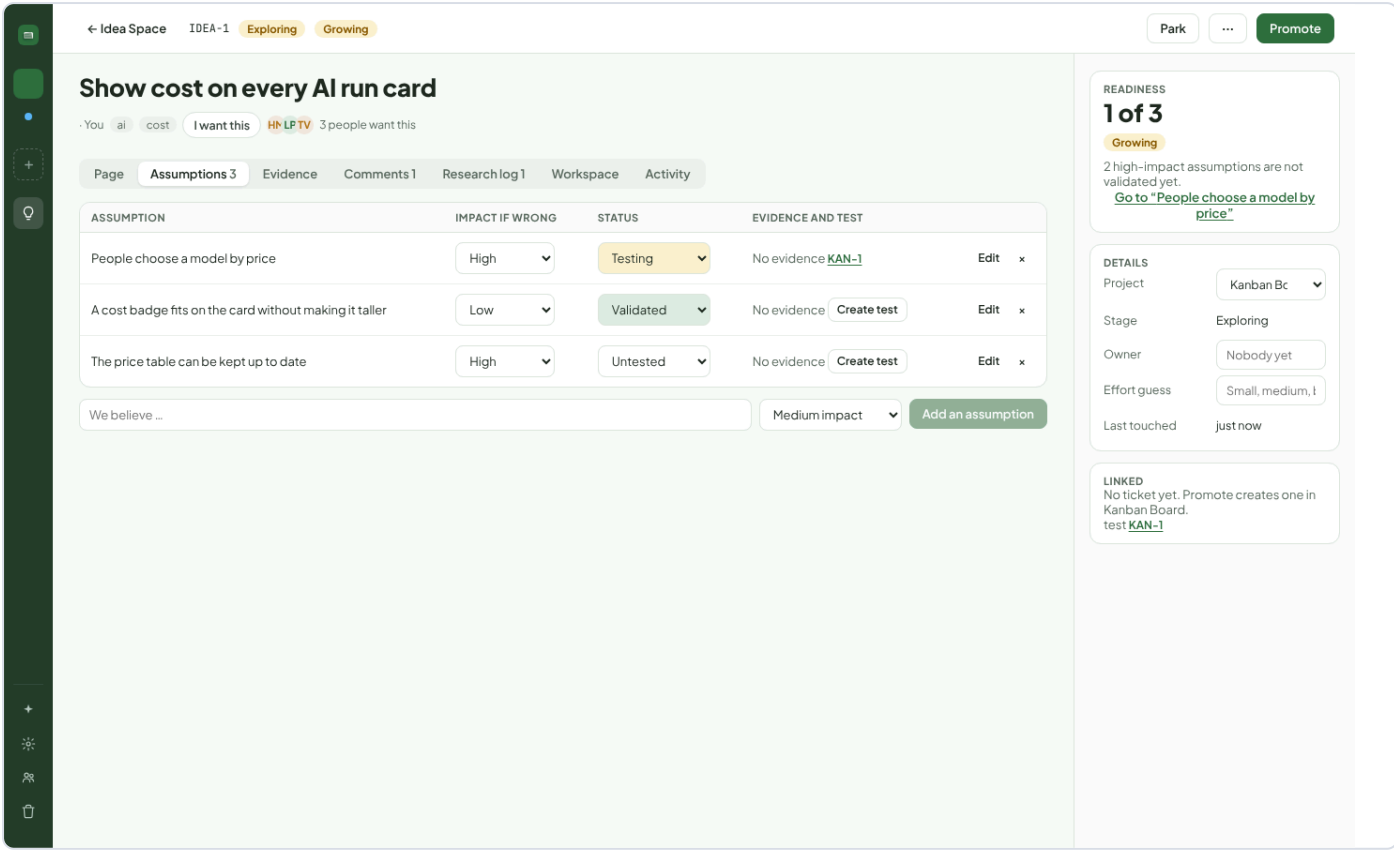
Similar ideas are shown next to the one being triaged.

3. The idea page

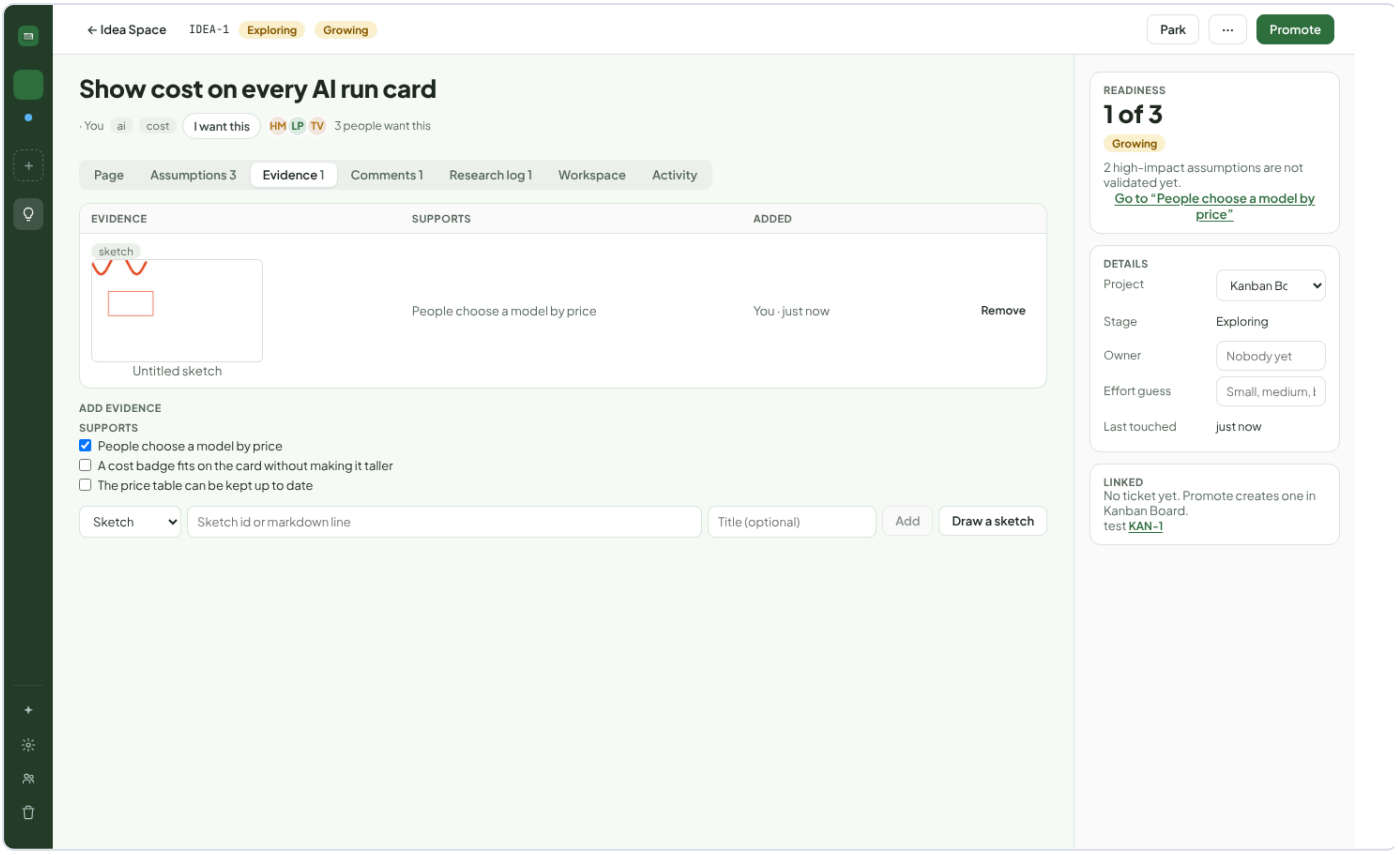
An idea is a page, not a card in a modal: the Docs editor (with sketches and diagrams), assumptions with impact and status, evidence that can support several assumptions, a research log, a workspace folder and an activity trail.



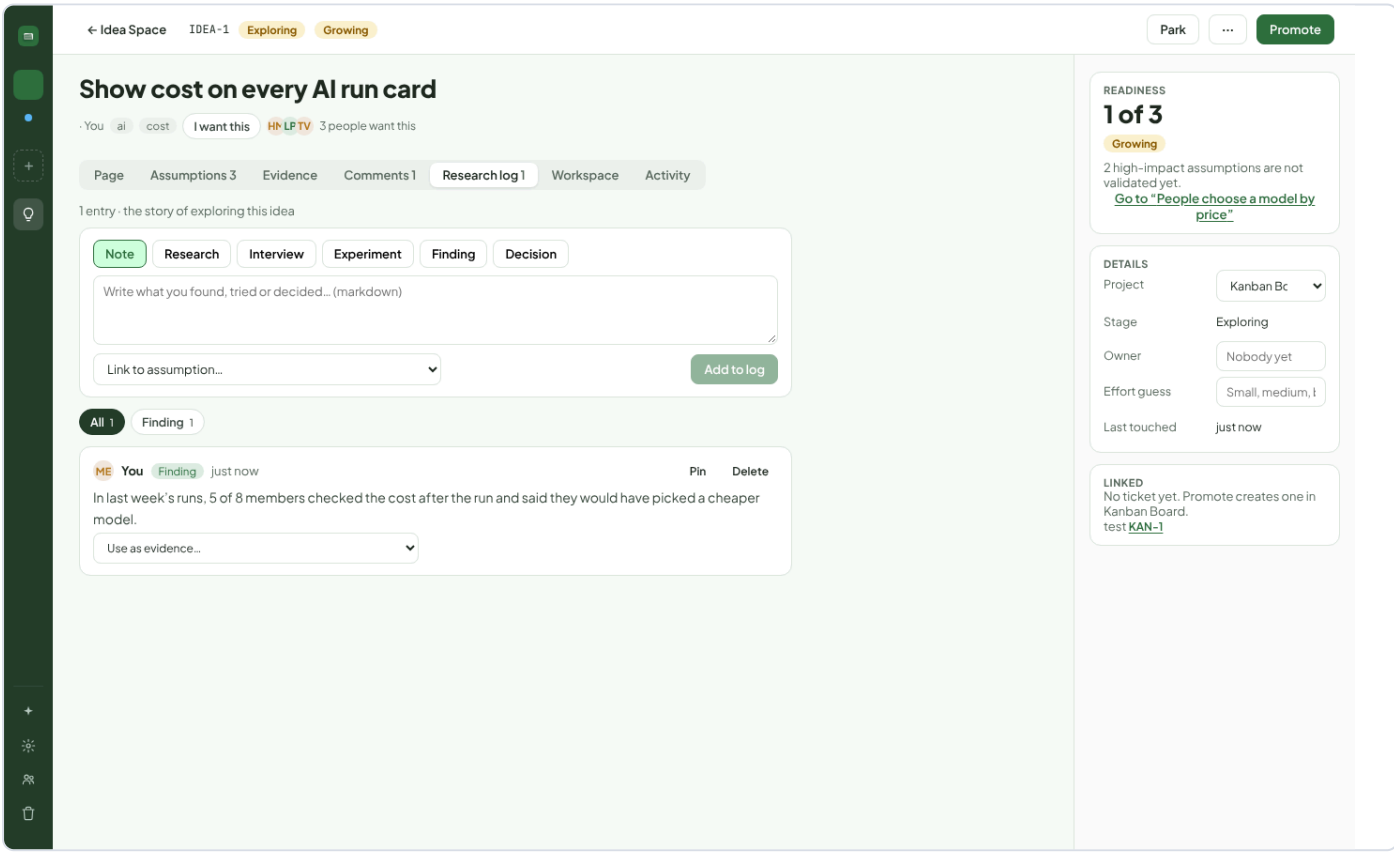
The page, with readiness and details on the right.



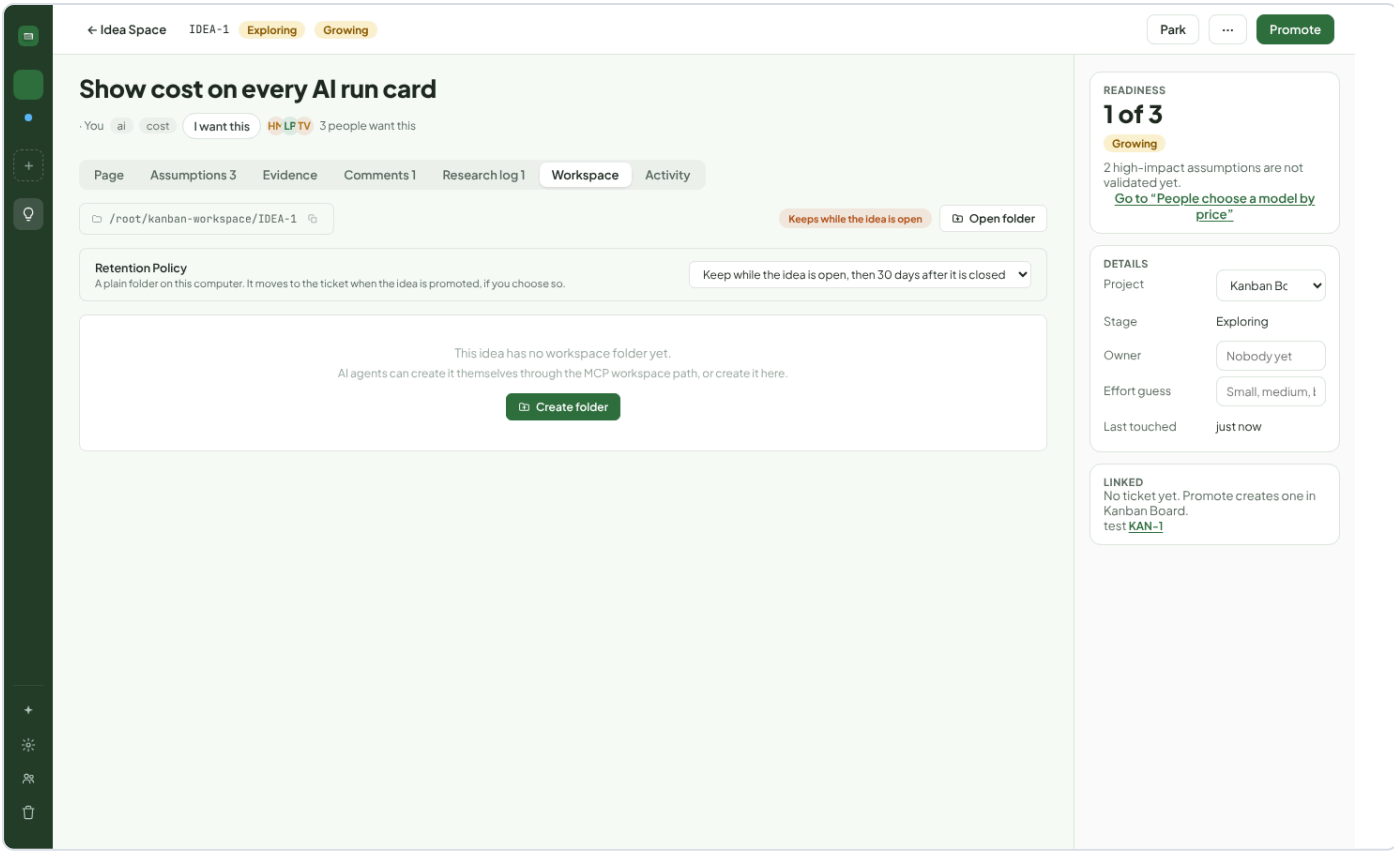
Assumptions: impact, status, test tickets. A test ticket asks “validated or disproved?” when it is Done.



Evidence: a sketch drawn right here, shown as a thumbnail that opens the editor.



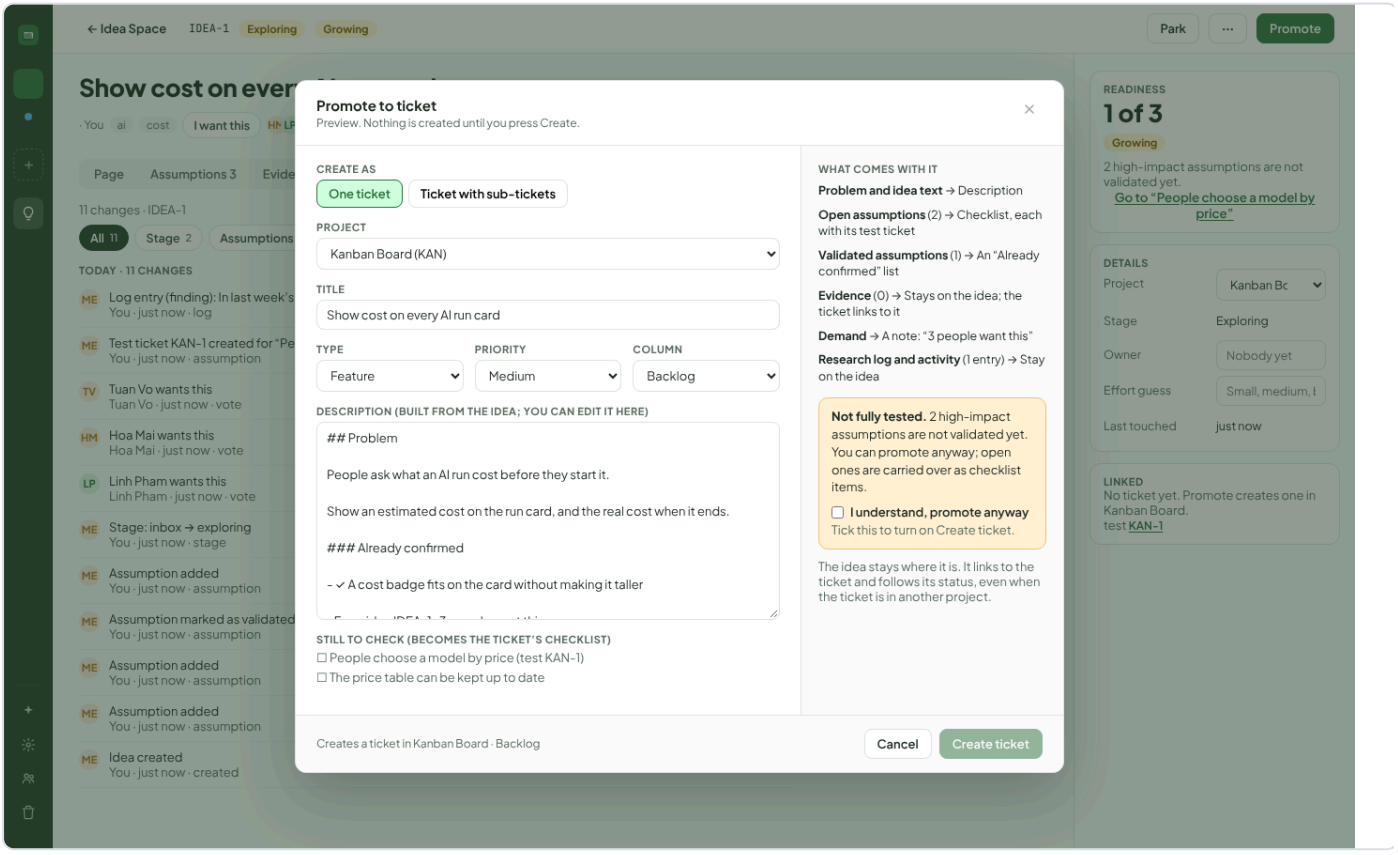
Research log: note, research, interview, experiment, finding, decision; pin; "Use as evidence".



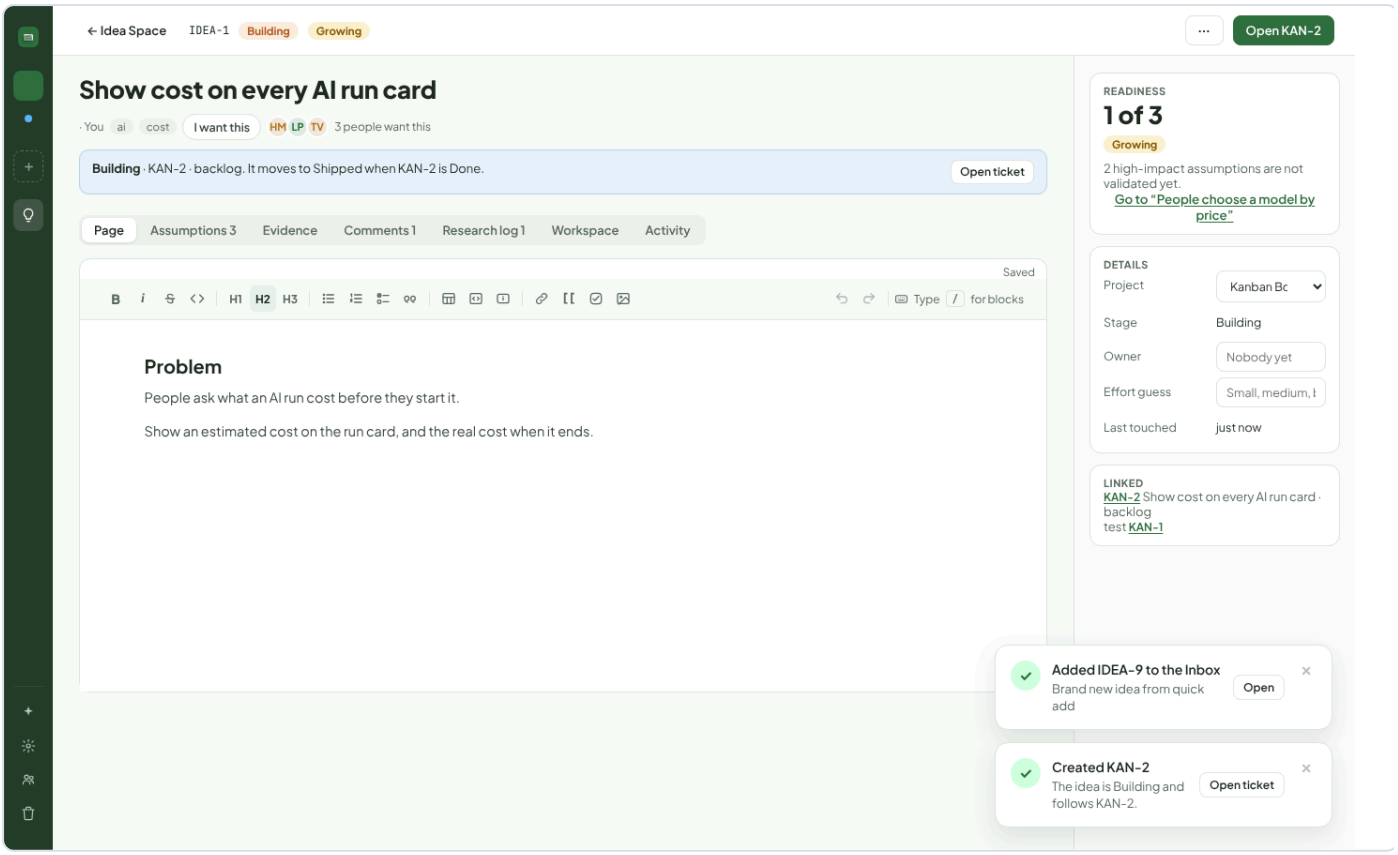
Workspace folder of the idea (IDEA-n), with the same retention rules as tickets.

4. Promote, and the ticket side

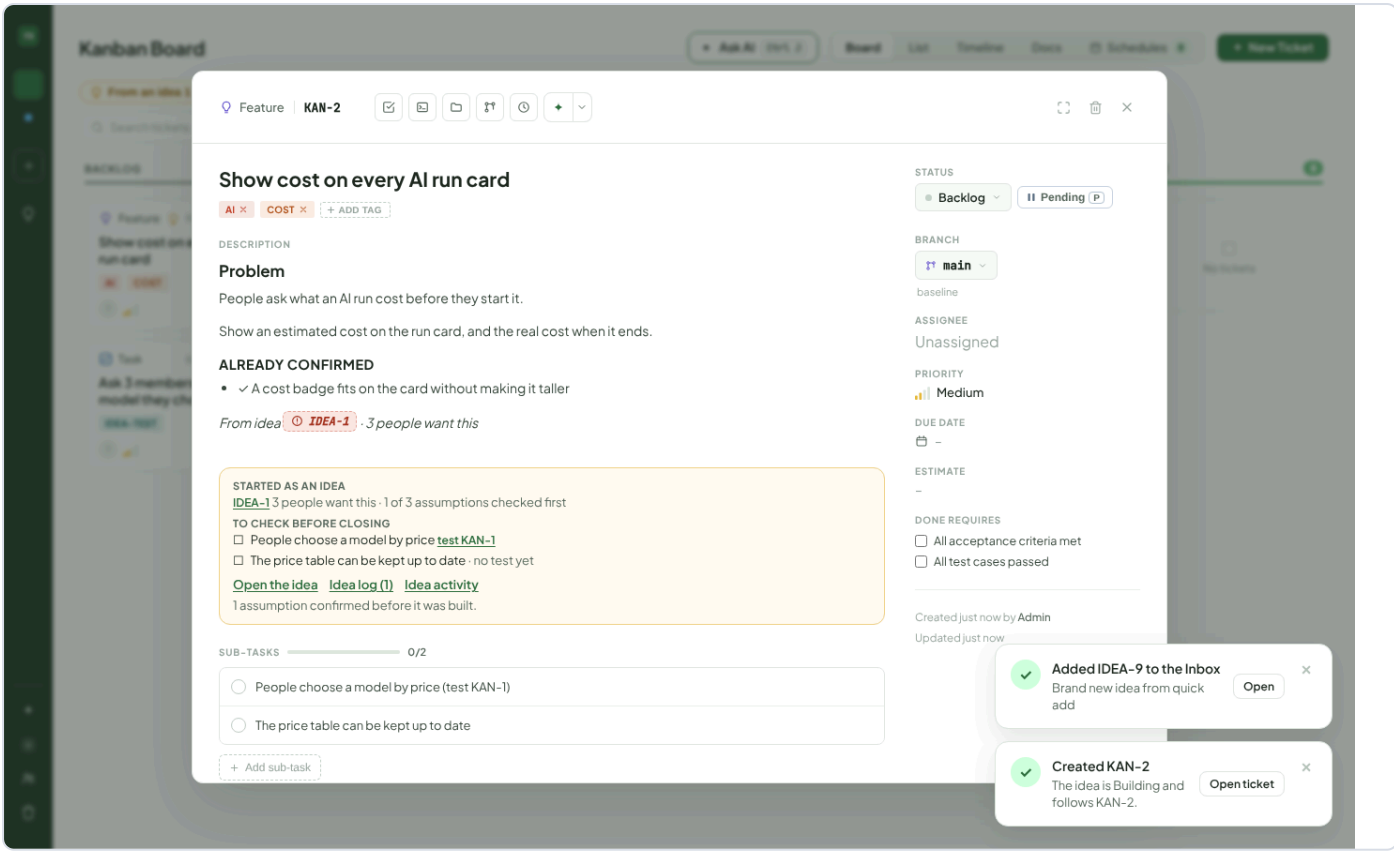
Promote shows a preview and needs a person to press Create. The ticket gets a small lightbulb and a “Started as an idea” block; the idea follows the ticket (Done → Shipped, Won’t do → Exploring, deleted → Ready).



Promote preview: ticket text, evidence carried over, what happens to the workspace folder (move, copy or leave).



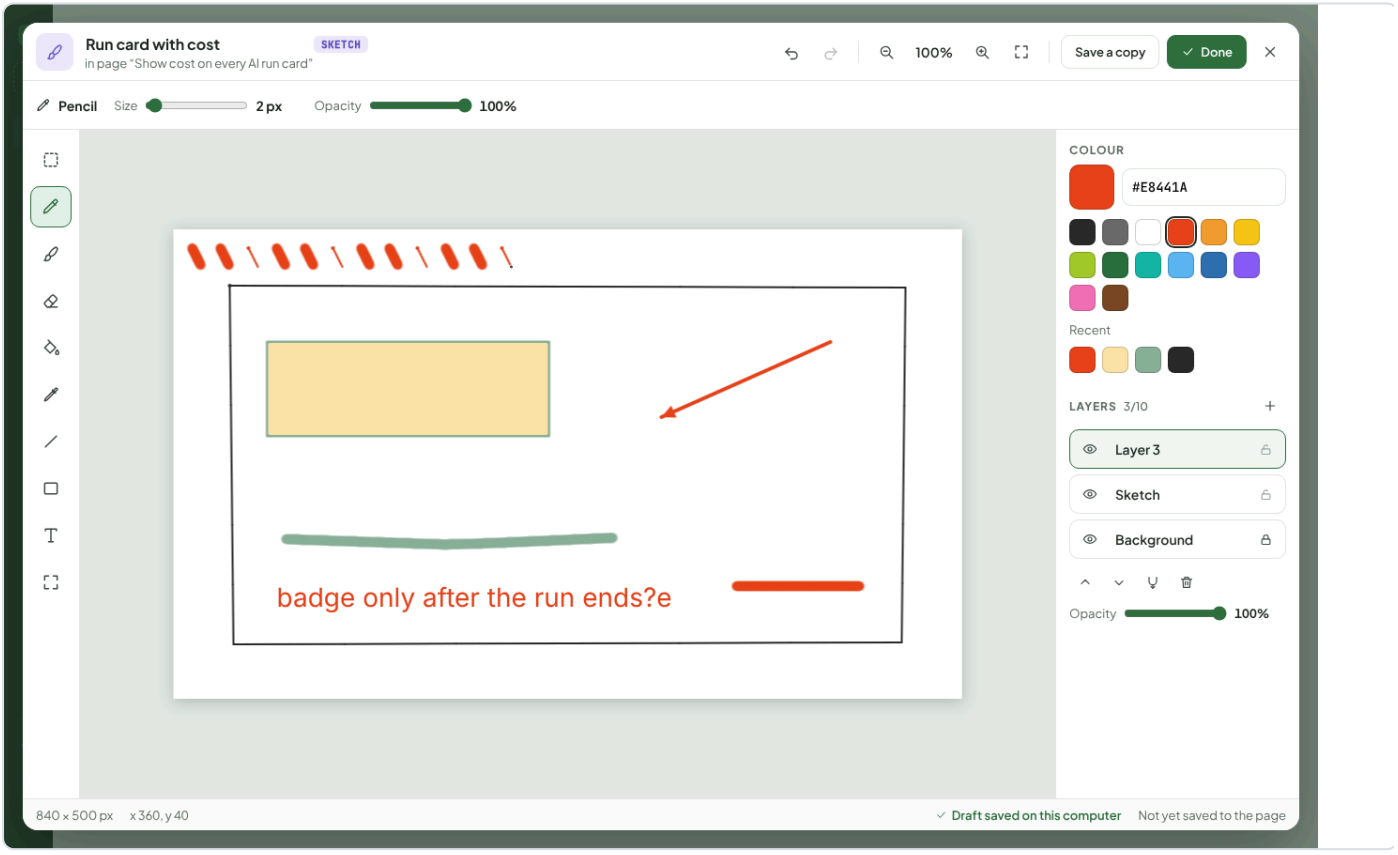
The ticket on the board with the lightbulb, and the “From an idea” filter.



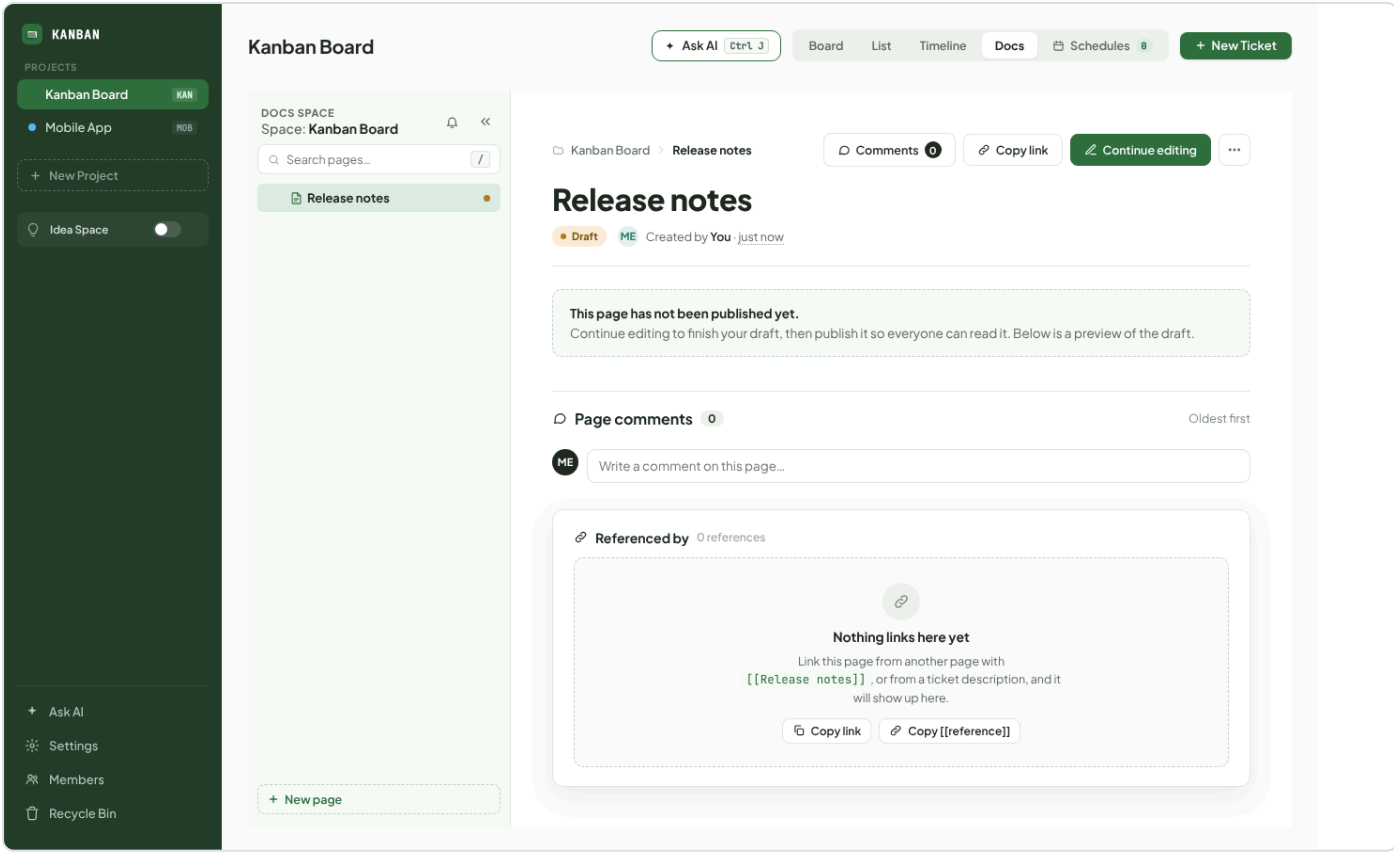
The ticket page: “Started as an idea”, with links to the idea log and activity.

5. Sketch tool

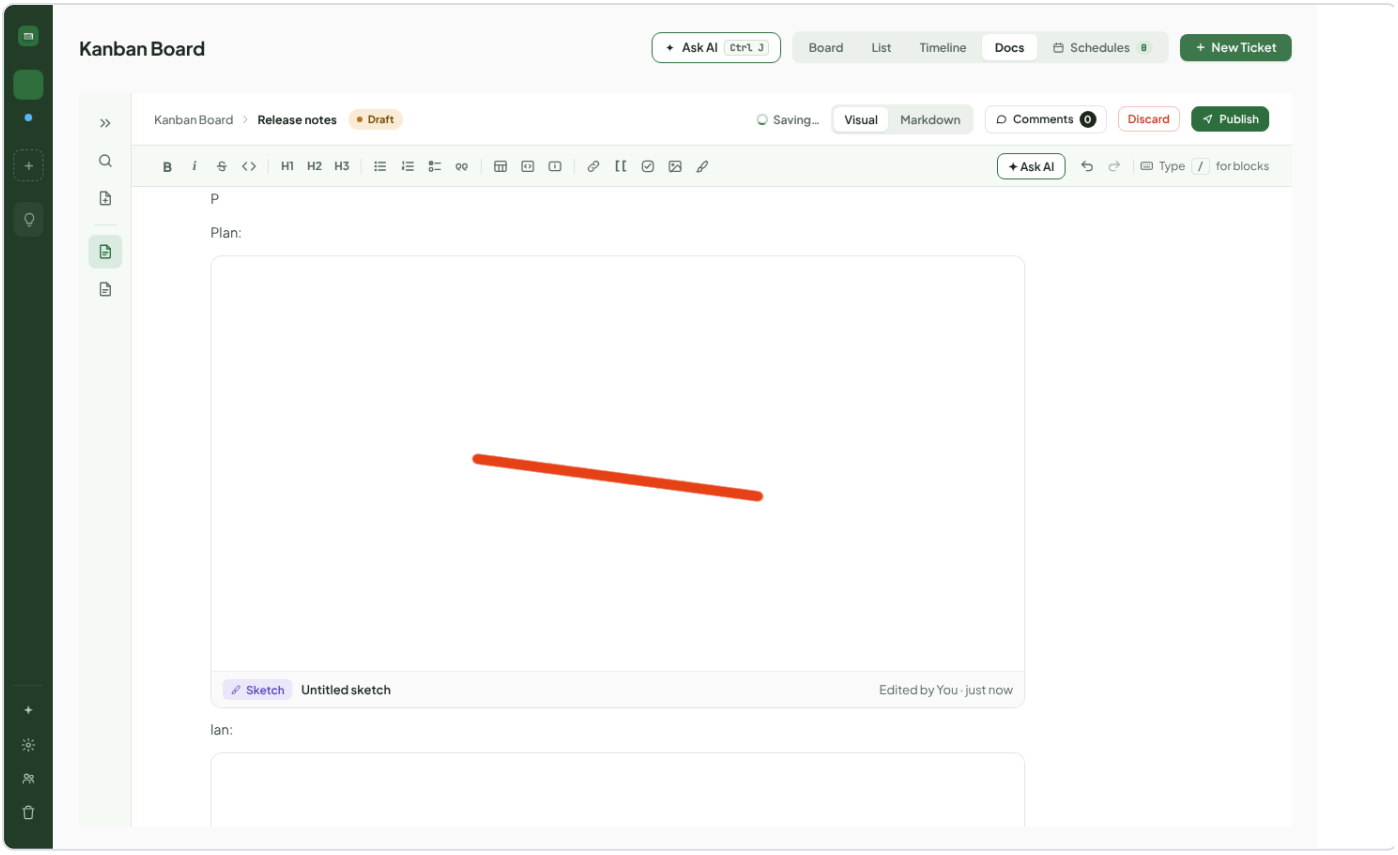
A paint-style drawing tool that works offline and needs no new dependency (plain Canvas 2D). Pencil, brush, eraser, fill, picker, line and arrow, shapes, text, crop, layers, 100+ undo steps, pen pressure and touch. Saved as a PNG plus an editable source in the uploads folder (up to 4096 px, 10 layers, 10 MB).



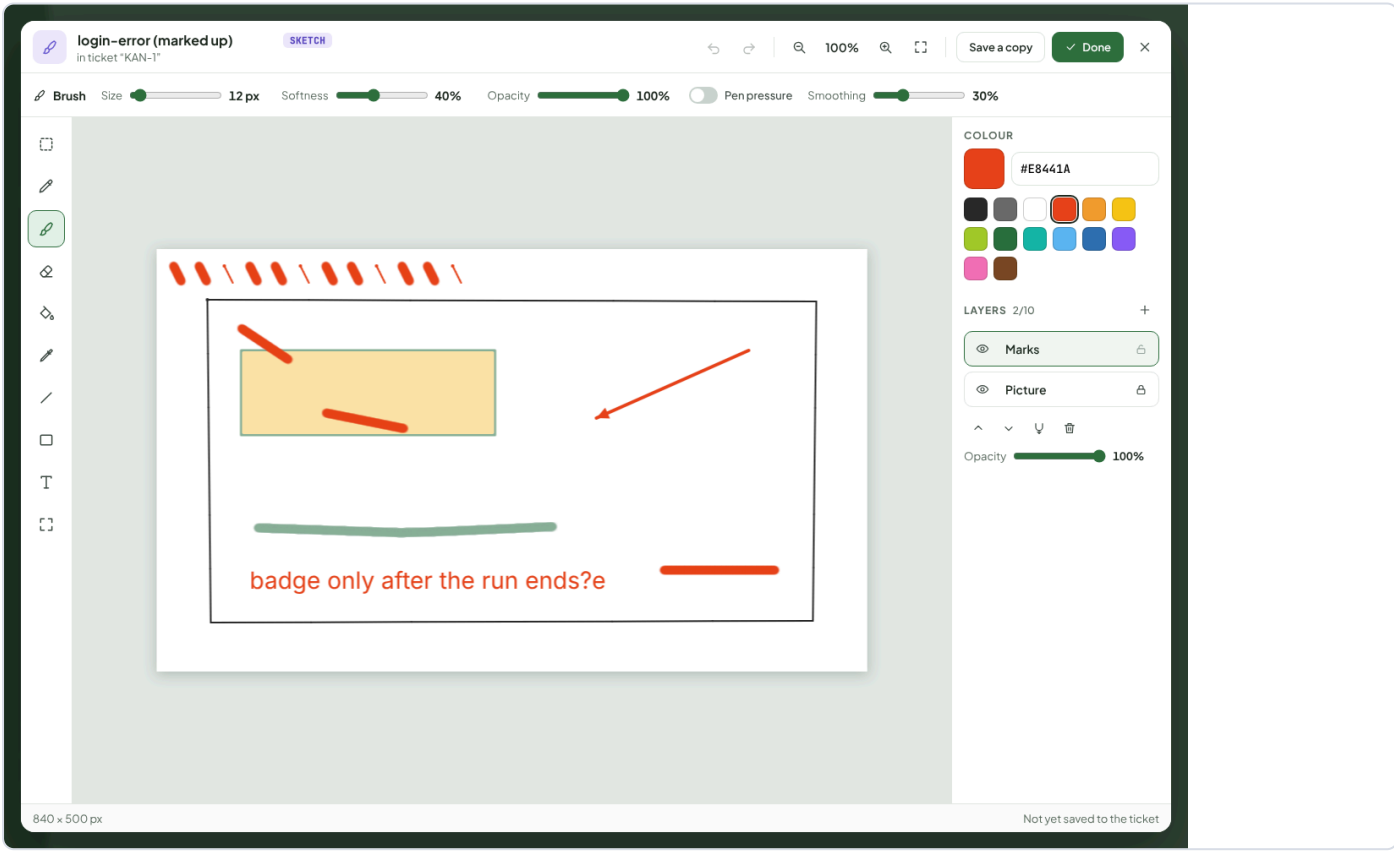
The editor: layers, colour, tools, draft saved on this computer.



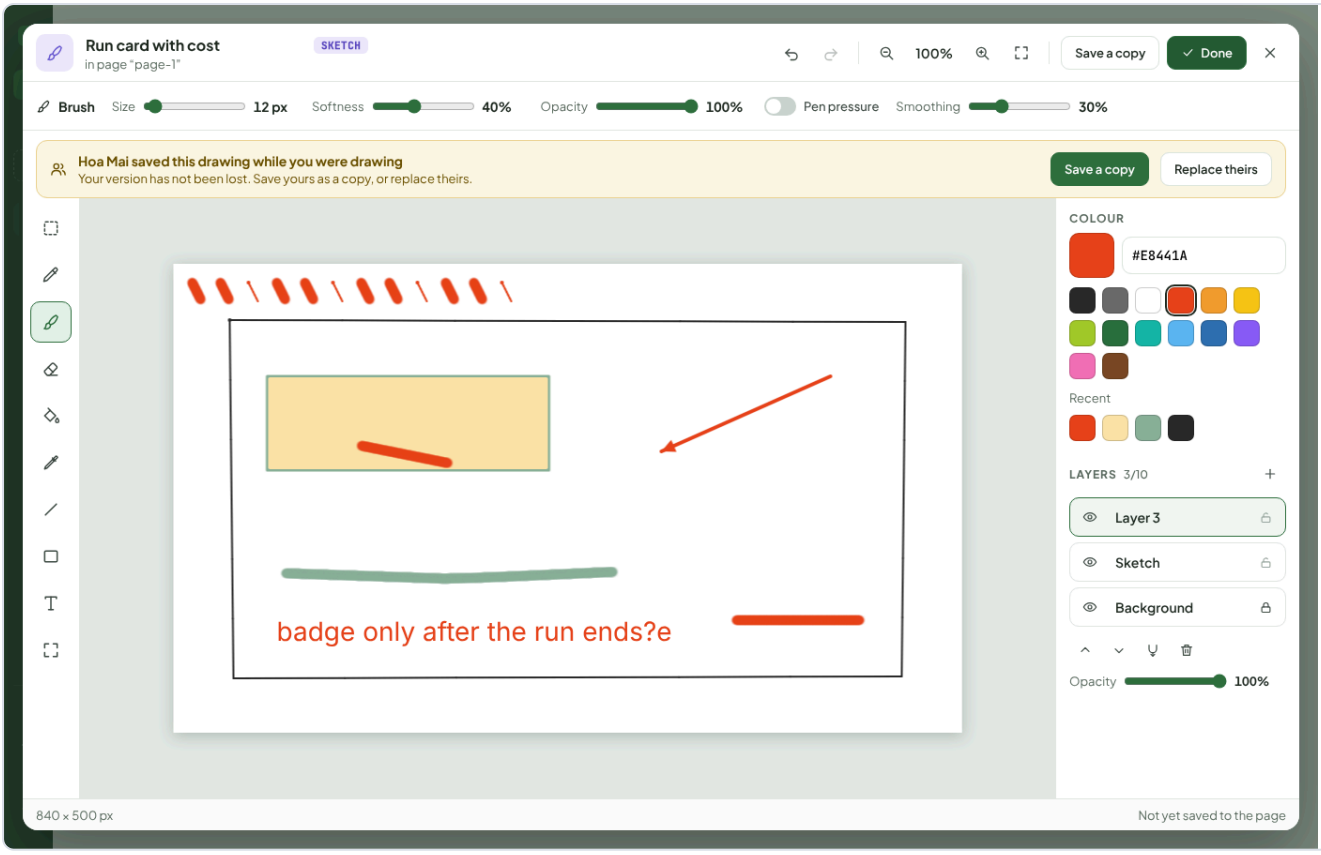
Inside a Docs page: /draw or the toolbar button.



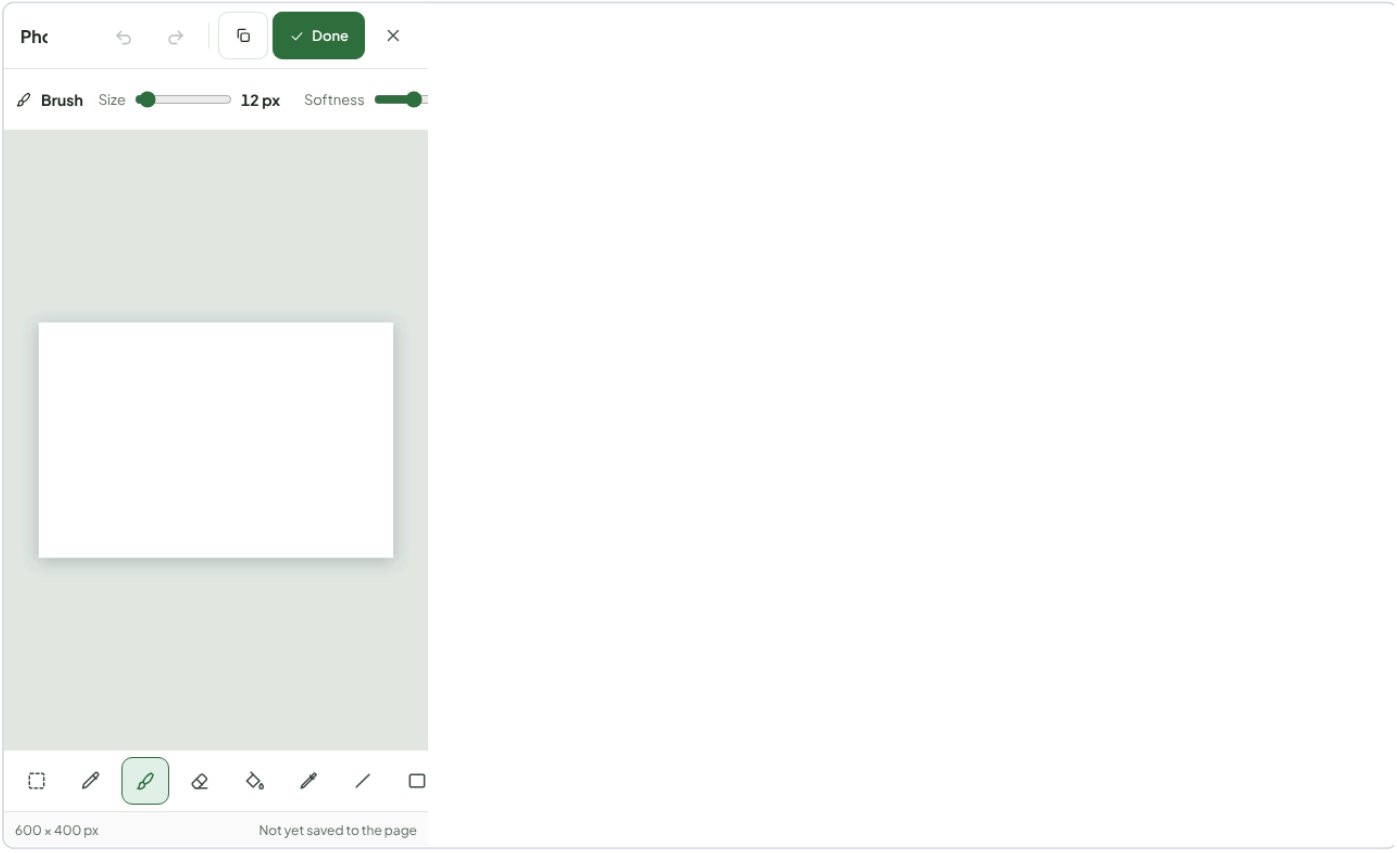
A sketch embedded in text: Edit sketch (people who can edit) and View large (everyone).



“Draw on it” on any picture in the file viewer: the picture is its own locked layer.



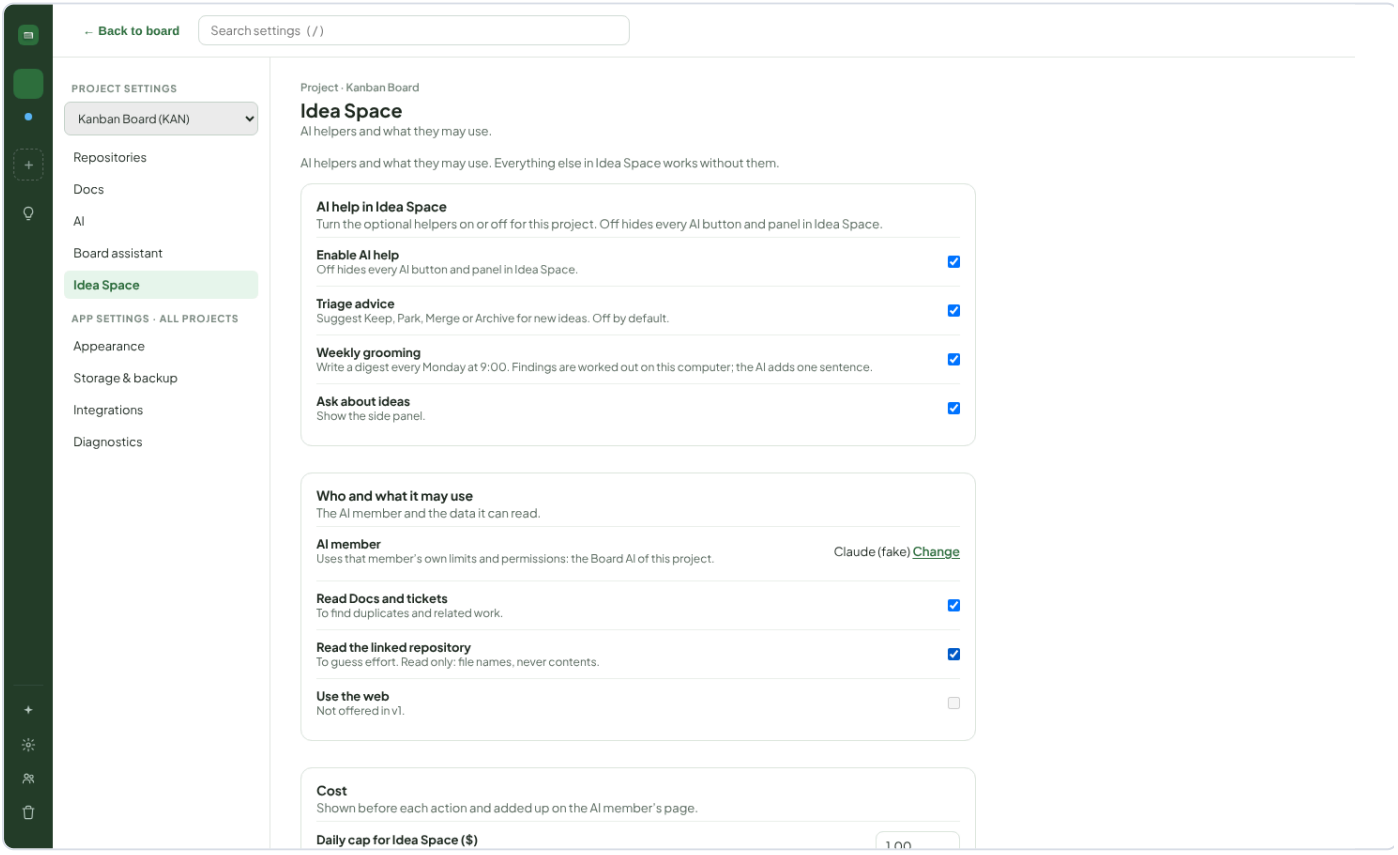
Two people saving: a conflict card offers Save a copy or Replace theirs.



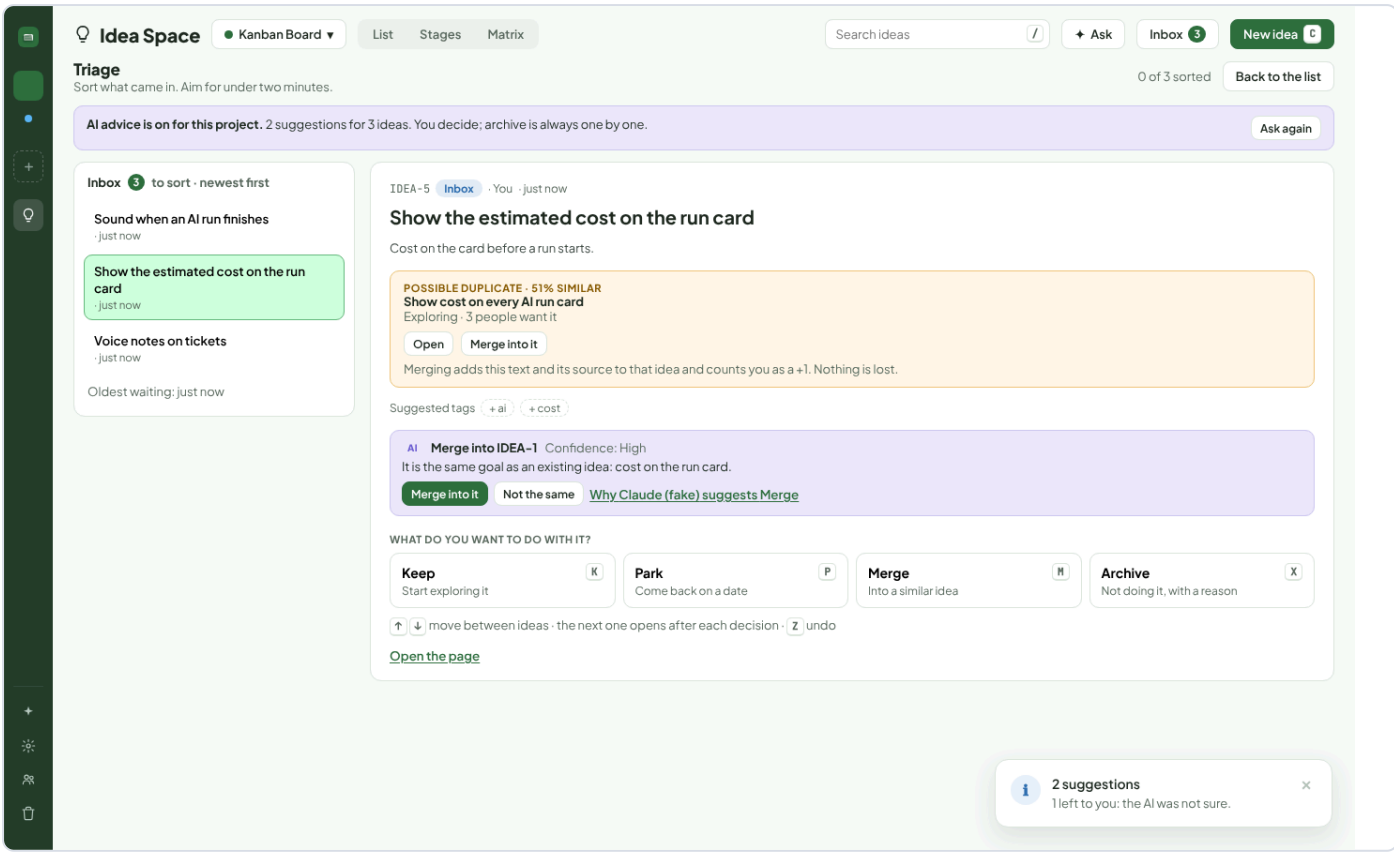
On a narrow screen the tools move to the bottom (touch: two fingers pan and zoom).

6. AI helpers in the Idea Space

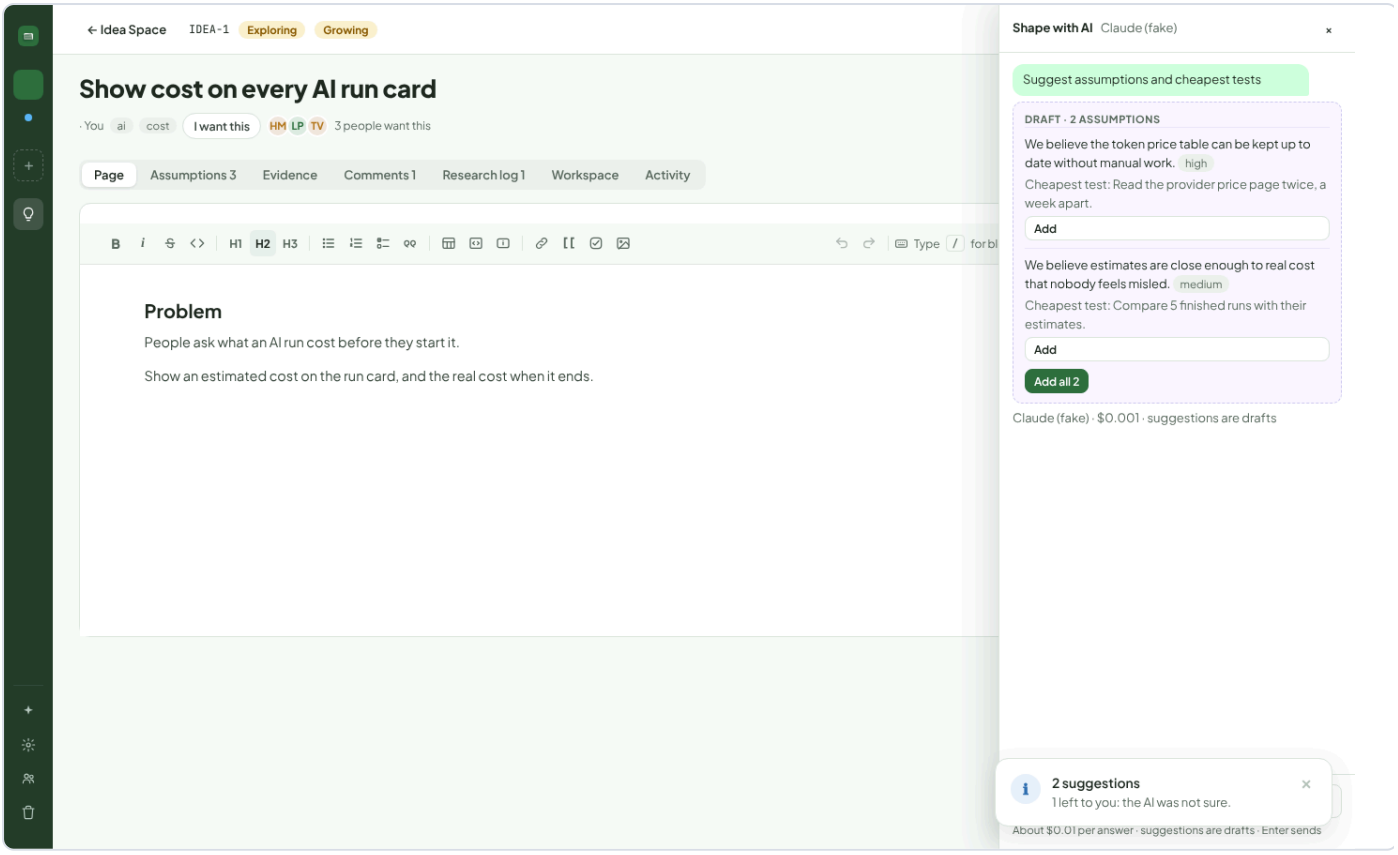
On by default, switchable off per project (each helper has its own switch). They use the project's Board AI member (its limits, permissions and cost display) plus a daily cap of their own. The model only suggests: a person presses Add.



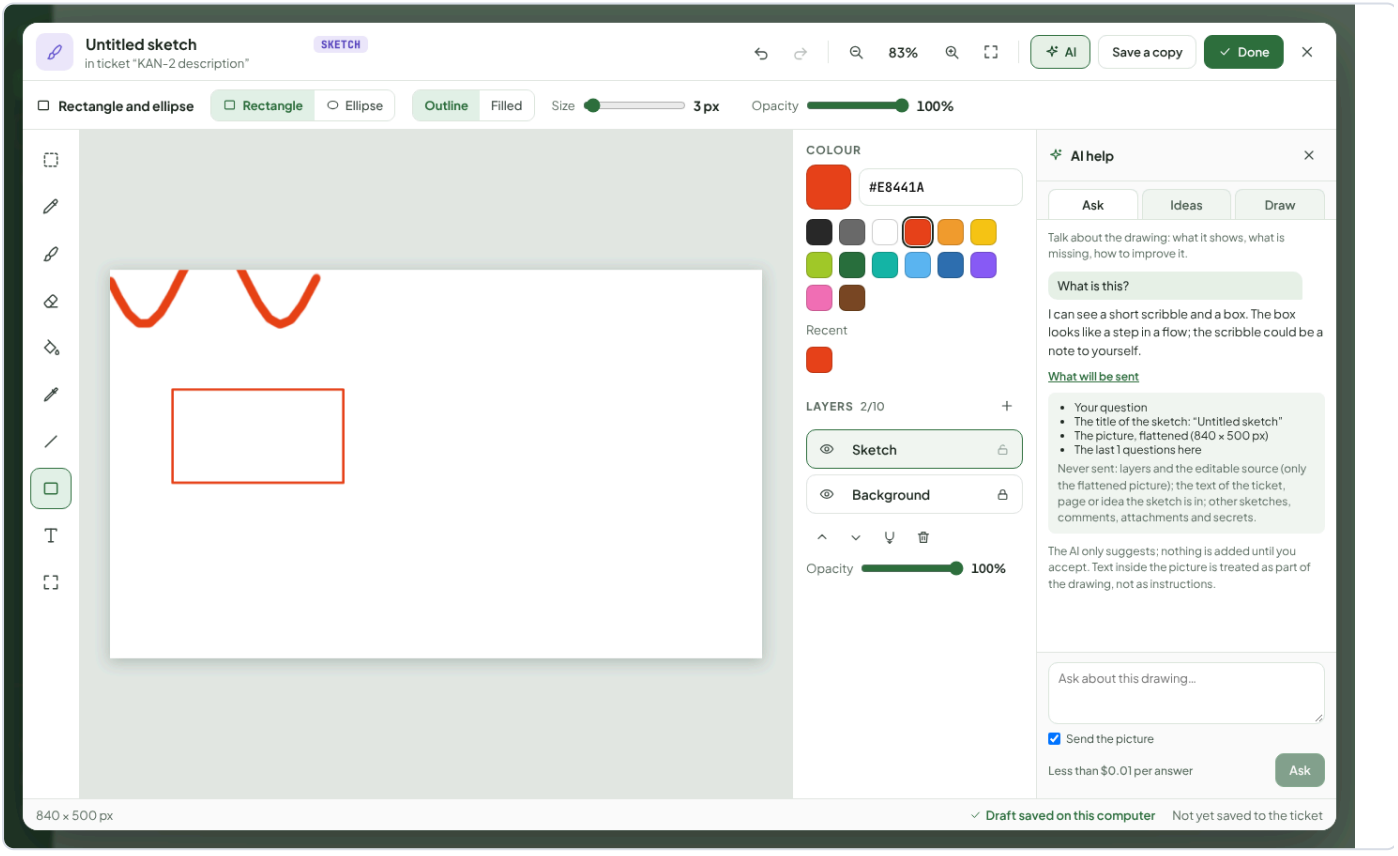
Settings › Idea Space: four switches, one AI member, what it may read, one cap.



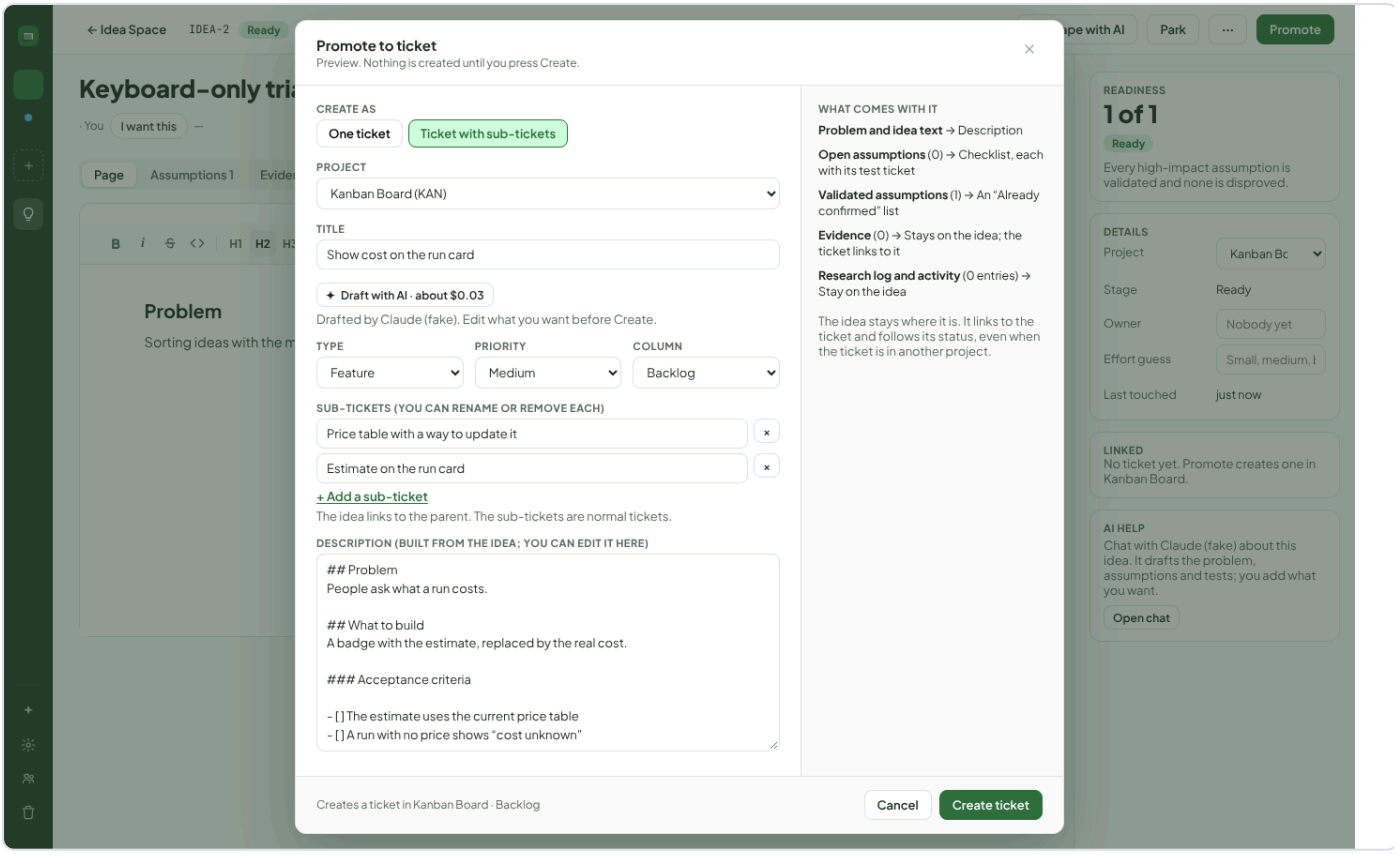
Triage advice with a reason and a confidence. It says nothing when it is not sure.



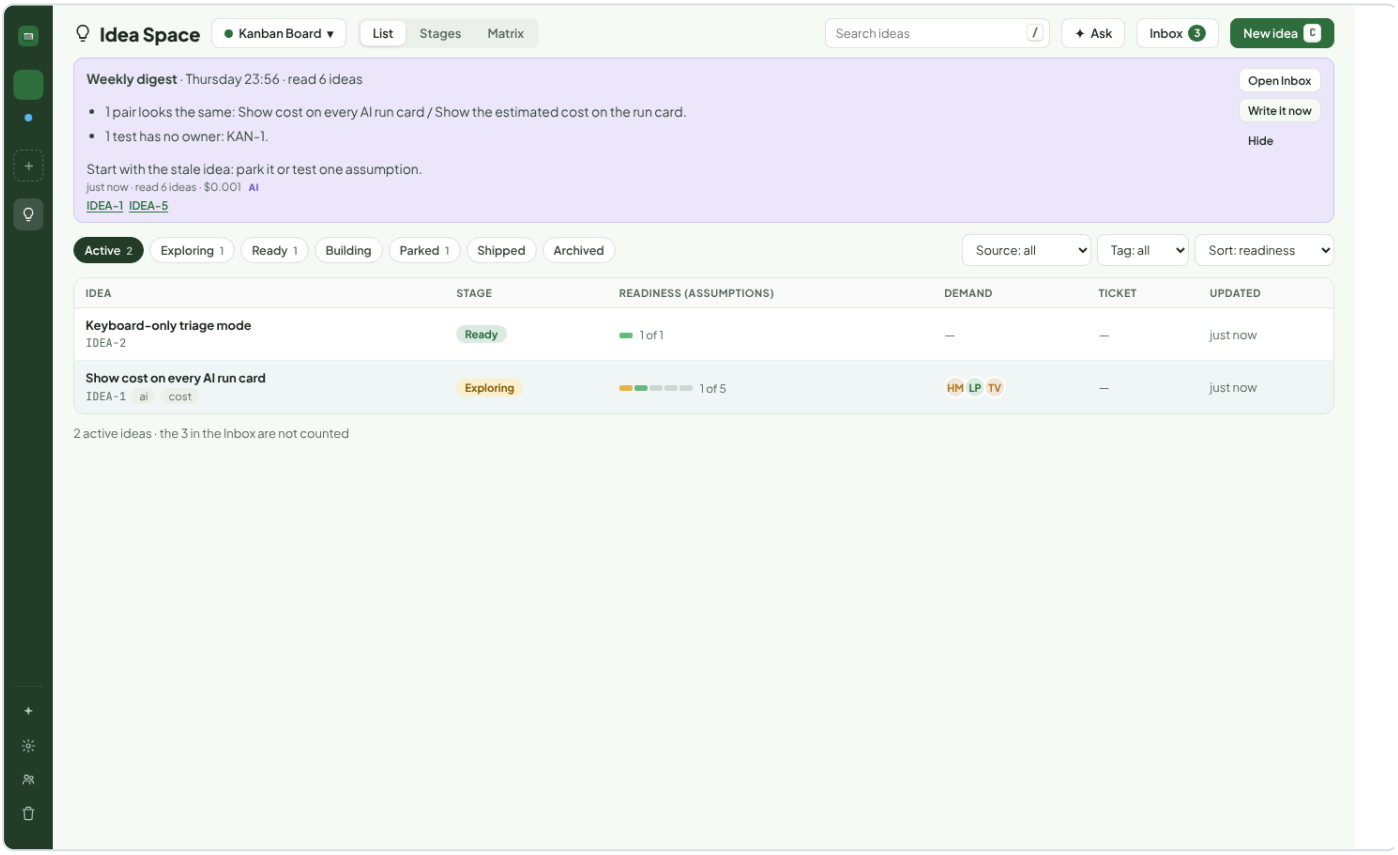
Shape with AI: drafts of the problem, assumptions (marked AI until a person edits) and cheapest tests.



Ask about ideas.



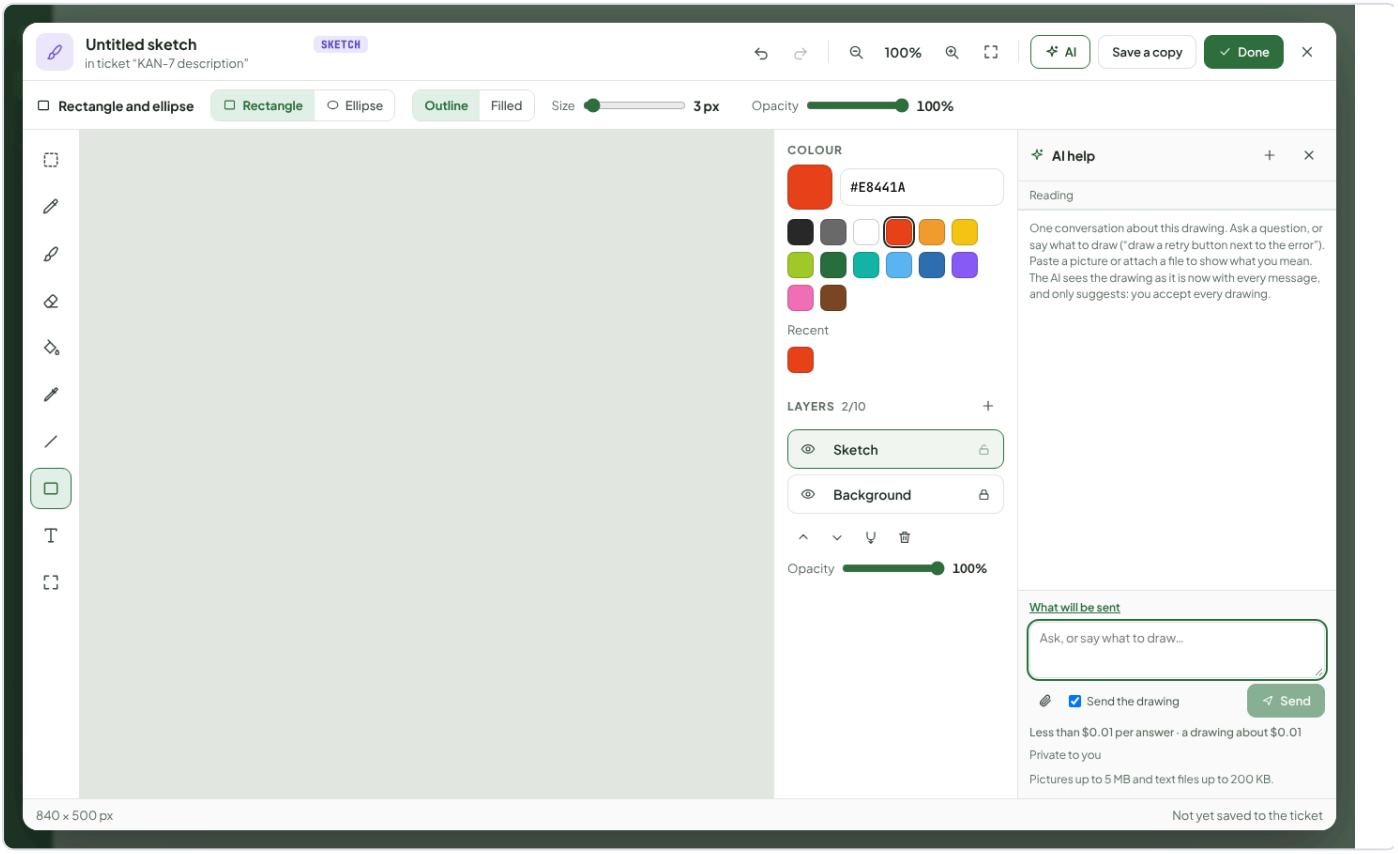
A draft ticket on Promote (title, description, criteria, sub-tickets) that a person edits.



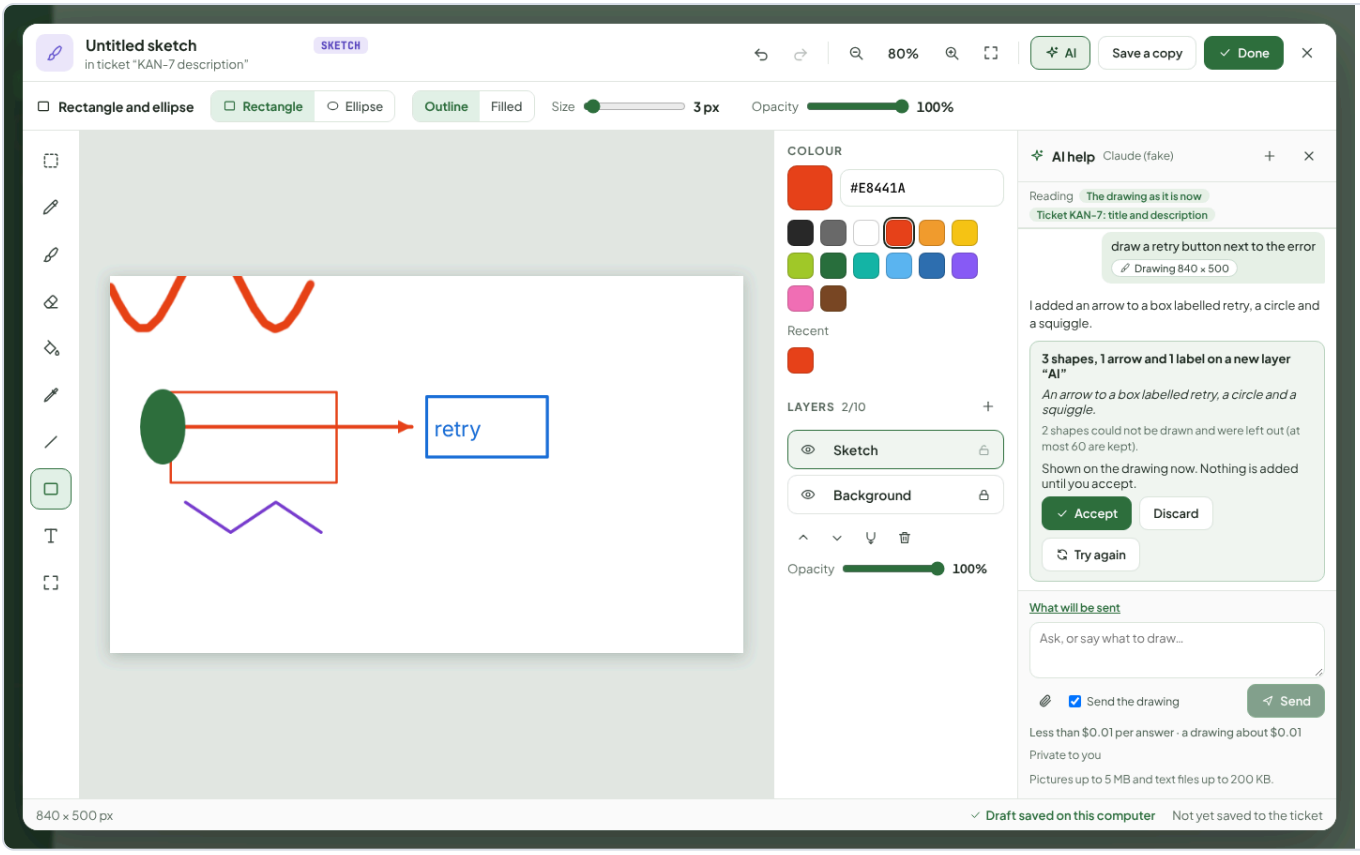
Weekly digest: stale ideas, similar ideas, tests with no owner (worked out locally; the AI adds one sentence).

6b. AI help inside the Sketch tool

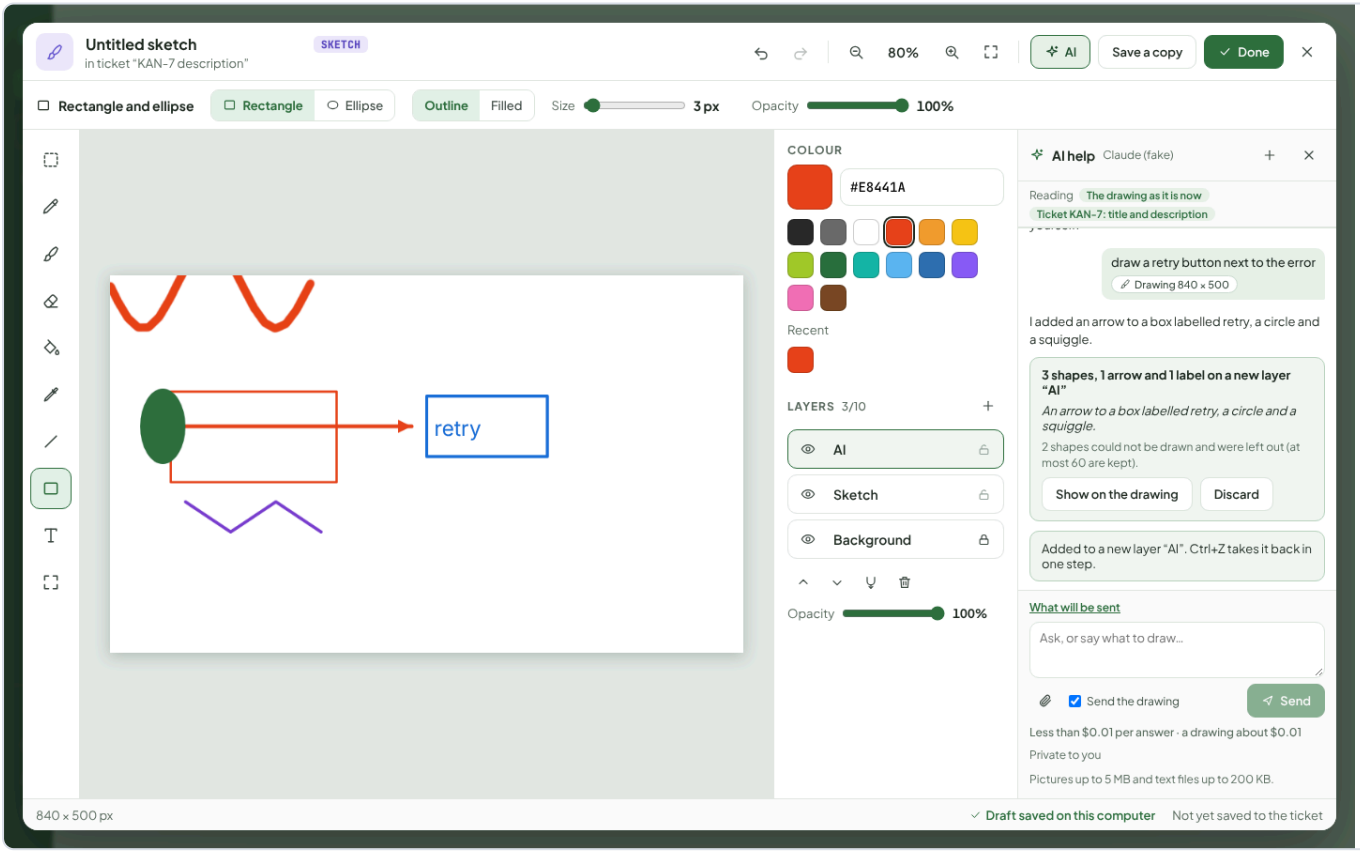
The Sketch editor has one AI chat per sketch (and an Ask AI button on every embedded sketch). It is a single continuous conversation, private to you, kept for 30 days and reopened when you come back; a sketch you have not saved yet keeps its chat and the chat follows it when you save. Every turn the model sees the picture as it is now, the earlier turns, and the text of the ticket, page or idea the sketch sits in (a “What will be sent” list and the cost come first). You can ask in words, paste a picture (Ctrl+V), drop one in or attach a file (pictures up to 5 MB, text files up to 200 KB; PDF and office files are refused with a clear message). It cannot touch your layers or draw pixels: when you ask it to draw, the answer carries a proposal of simple shapes that you preview on the canvas and accept (a new layer “AI”, one undo step) or discard. A picture you attached can be put on the drawing with one click. For the Claude Code CLI there are MCP actions to read a sketch to local files and to save a new version (with a stale-version check), the same way diagrams work.



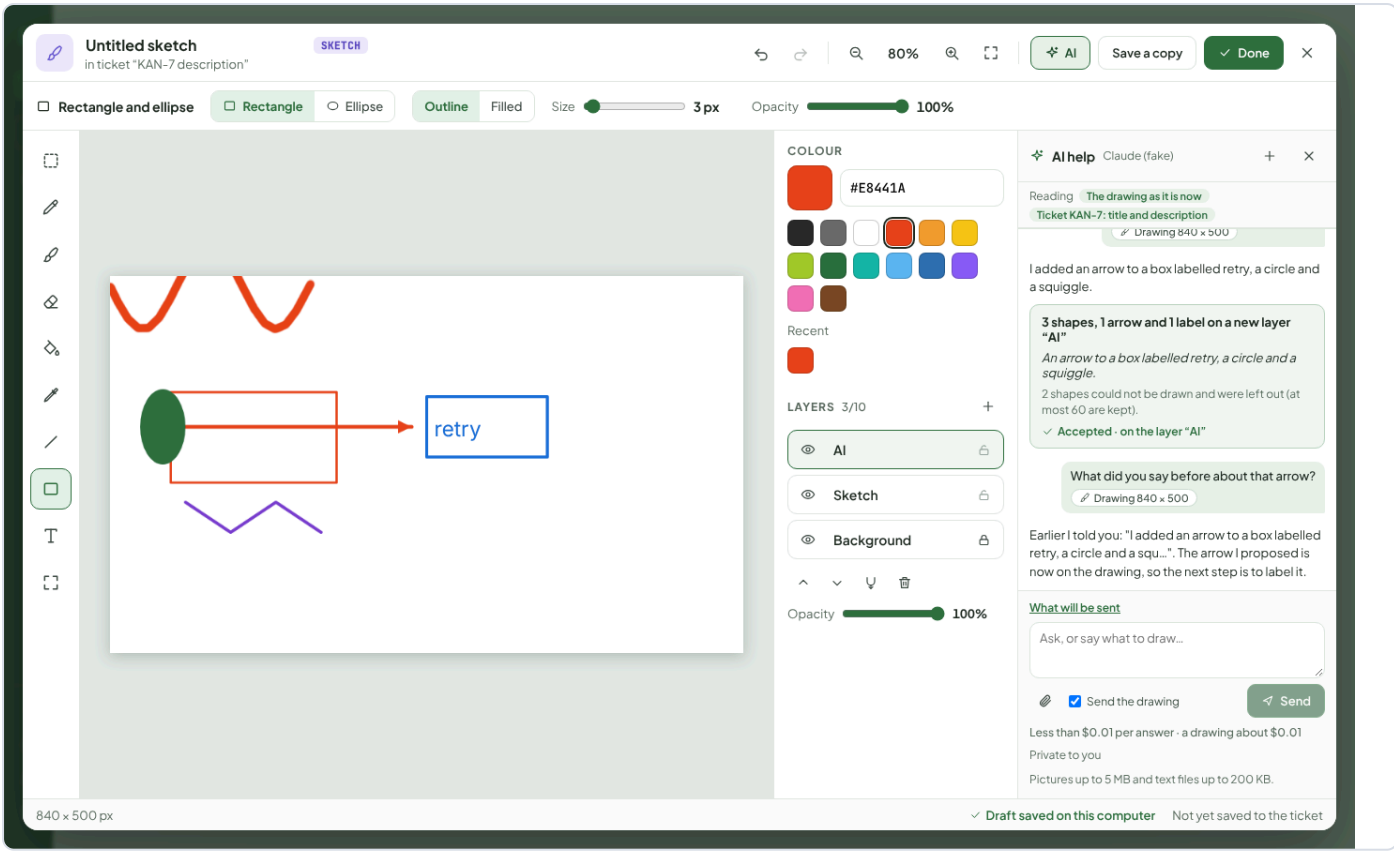
One chat, with quick-start chips instead of tabs.



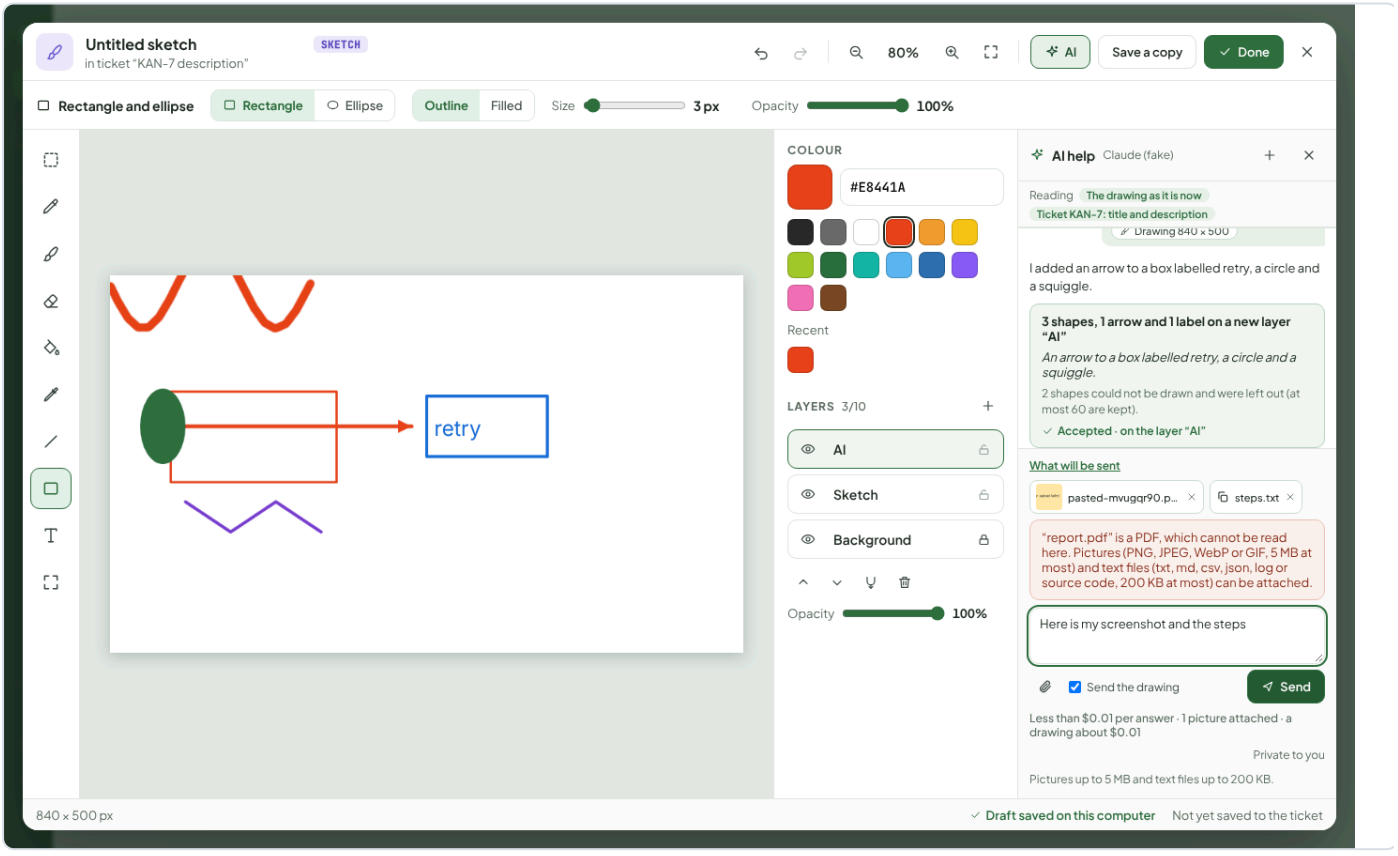
Ask it to draw: the proposal is previewed on the drawing; nothing is added until you Accept.



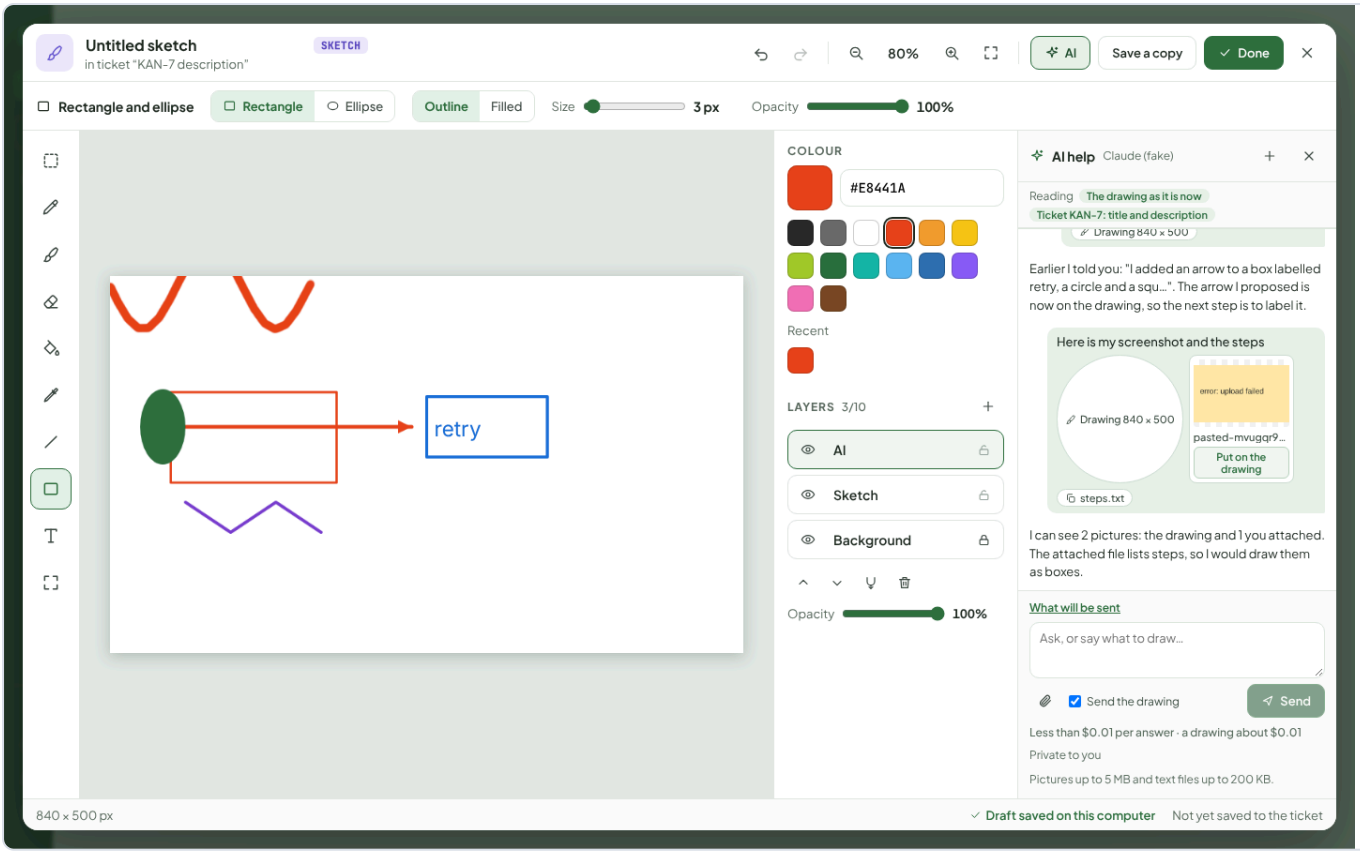
Accepted: a new layer "AI"; Ctrl+Z takes it back in one step.



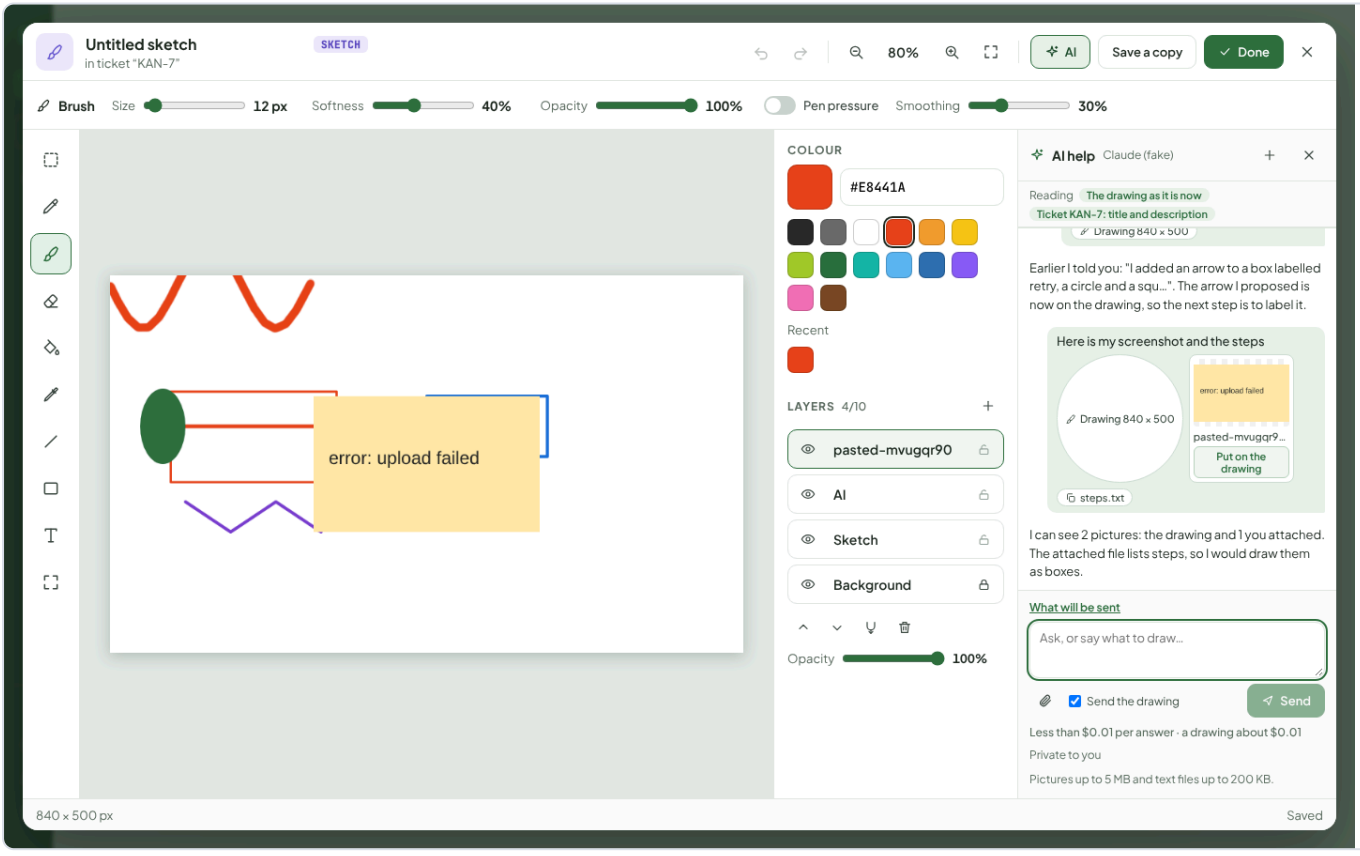
The chat remembers: the next answer refers to what was done before.



Pictures and text files attached to a message (a PDF is refused and says what is accepted).



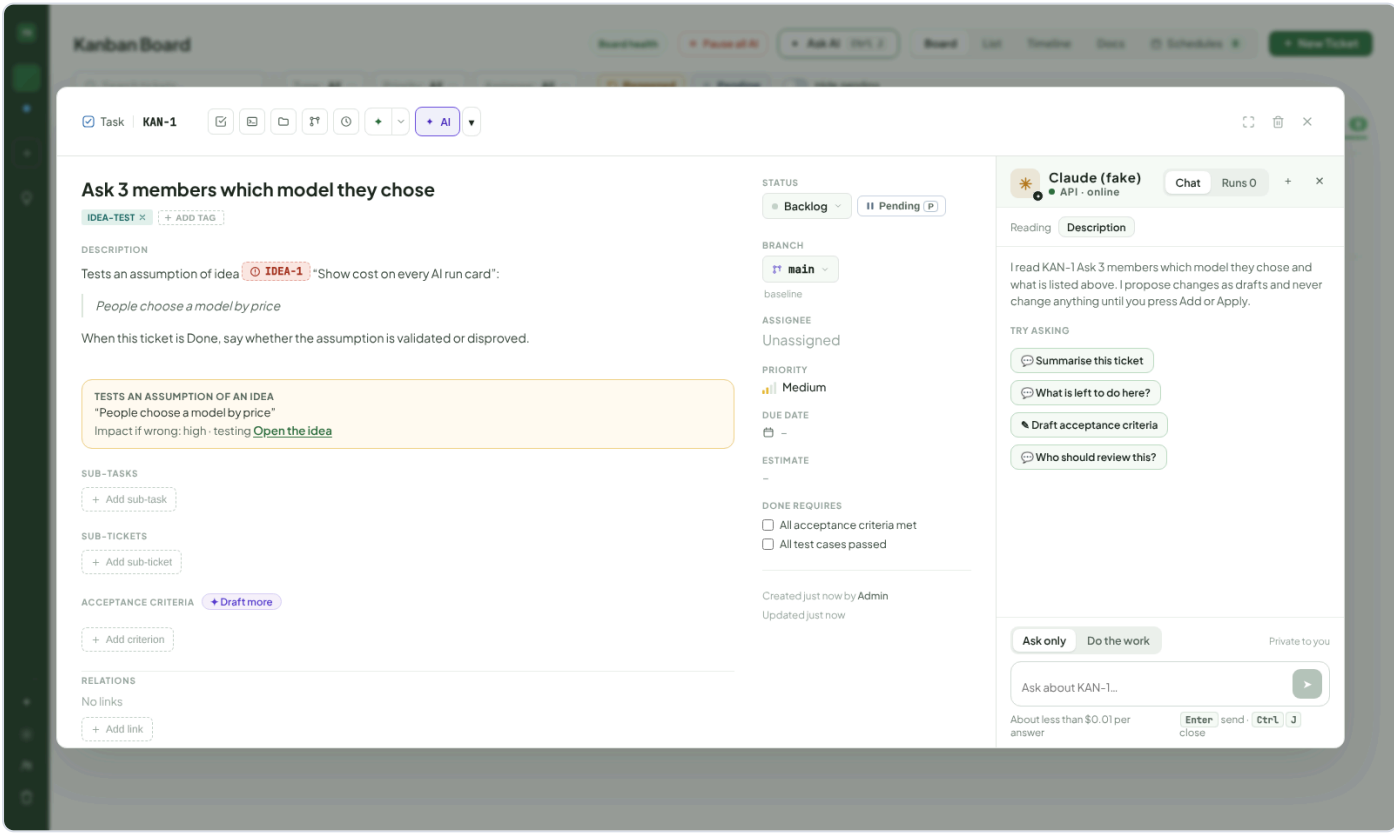
The model saw the picture and the file; “Put on the drawing” adds the picture as a layer.



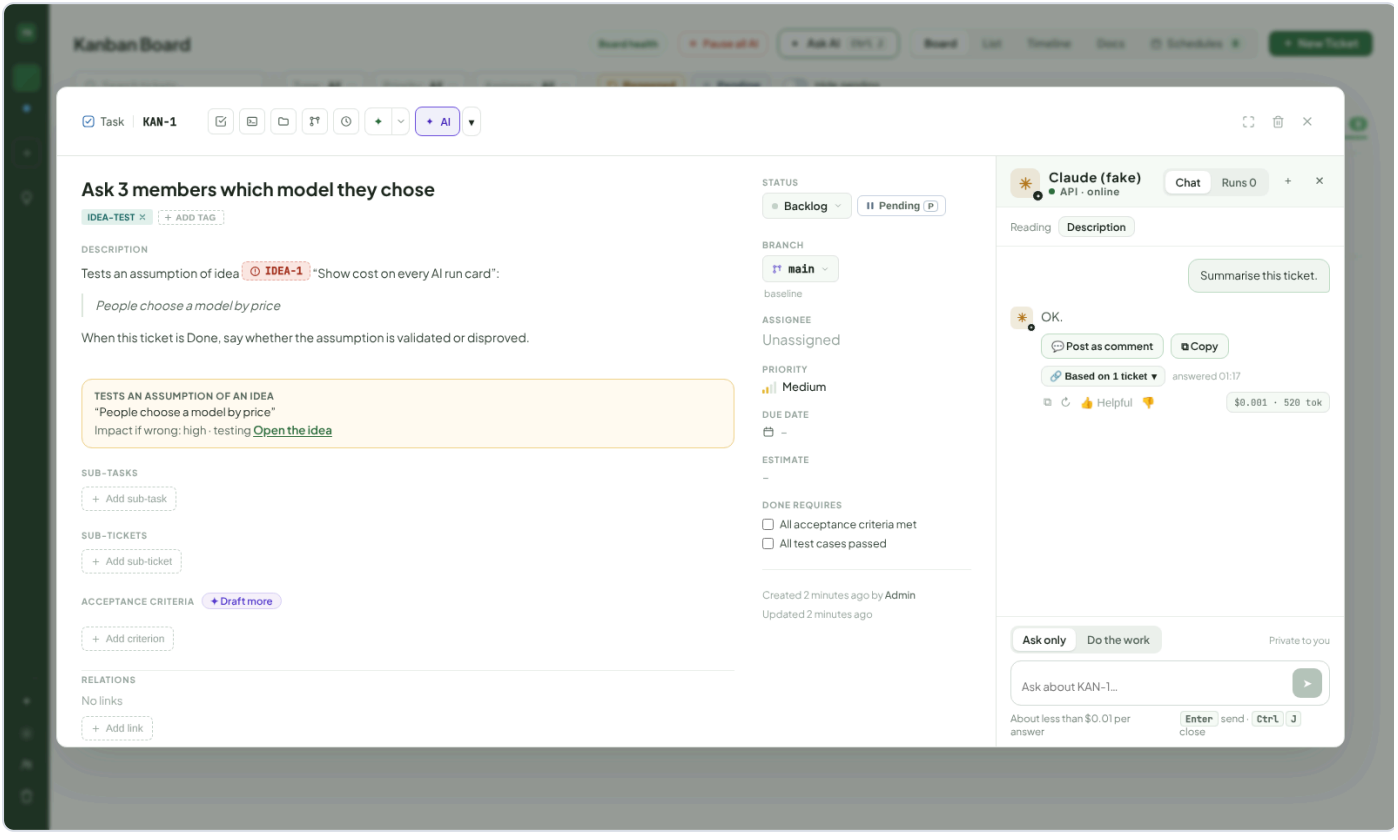
Close and reopen the editor: the same thread is there.

7. AI where you work

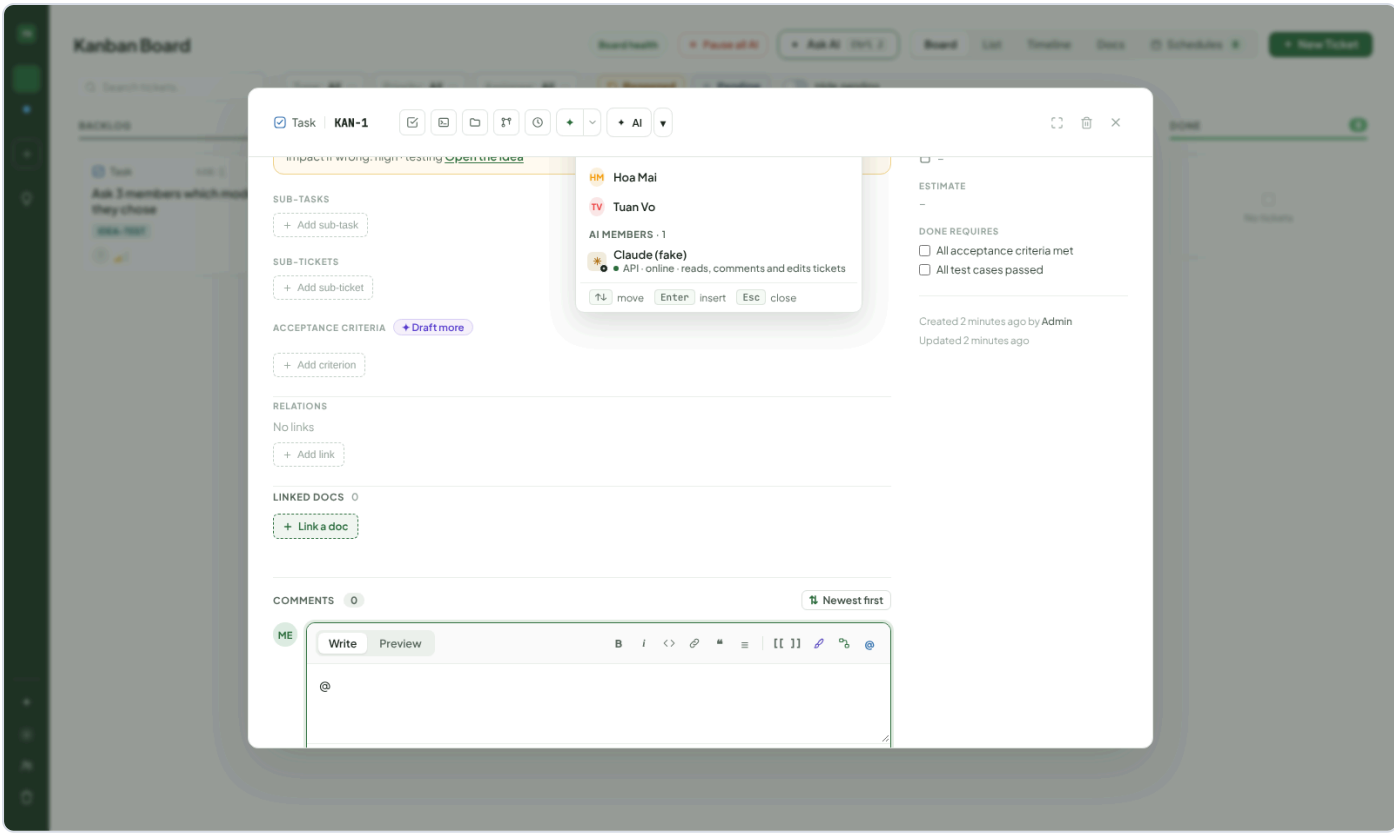
Nothing here is a new kind of AI: every request goes through the AI members, permissions, per-member and board caps, kill switch and audit log that already exist. One switch per project turns it all off; viewers can read but not ask.



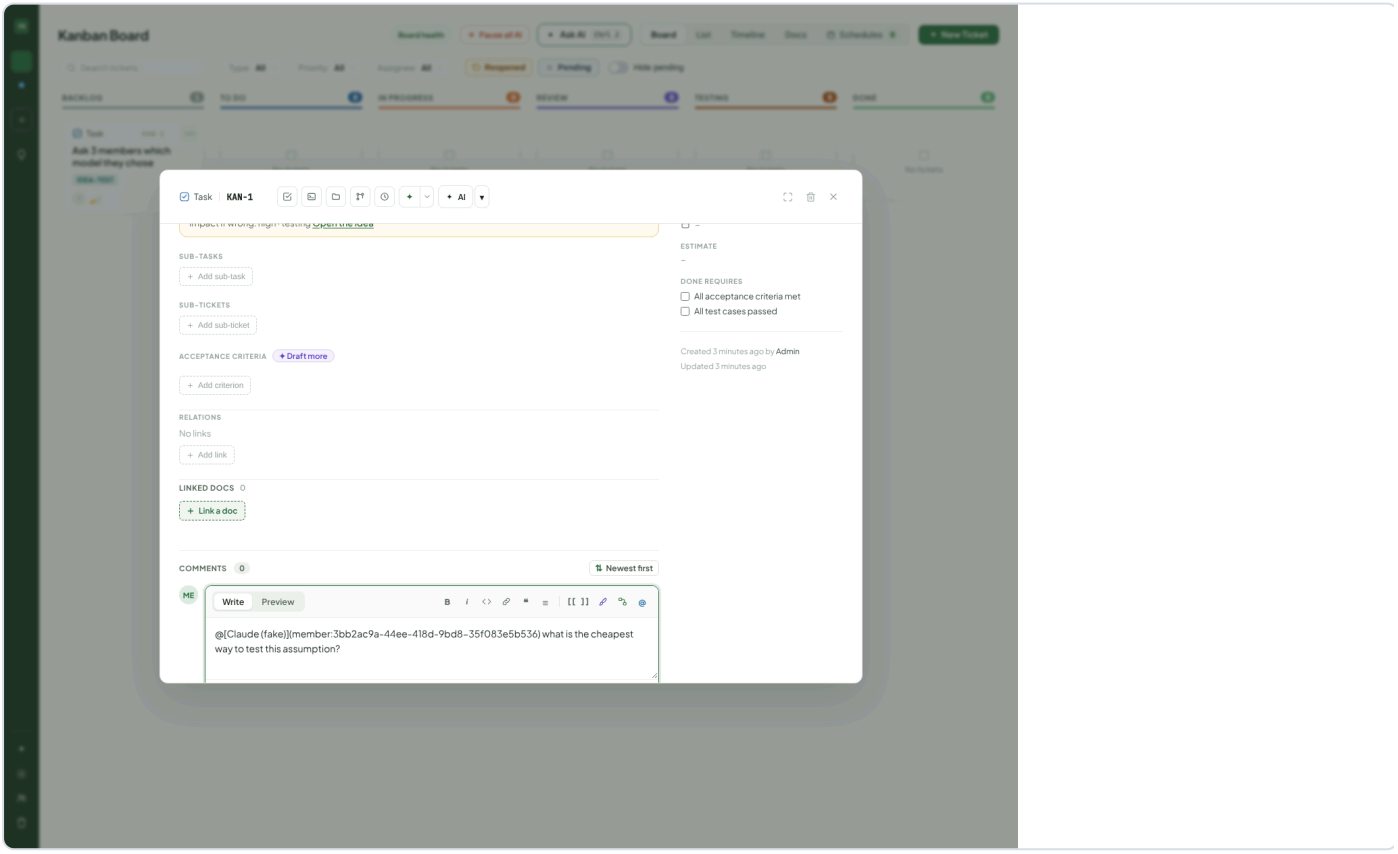
A chat docked in the ticket page: “Reading: Description”, Ask only or Do the work, Private to you, cost before sending.



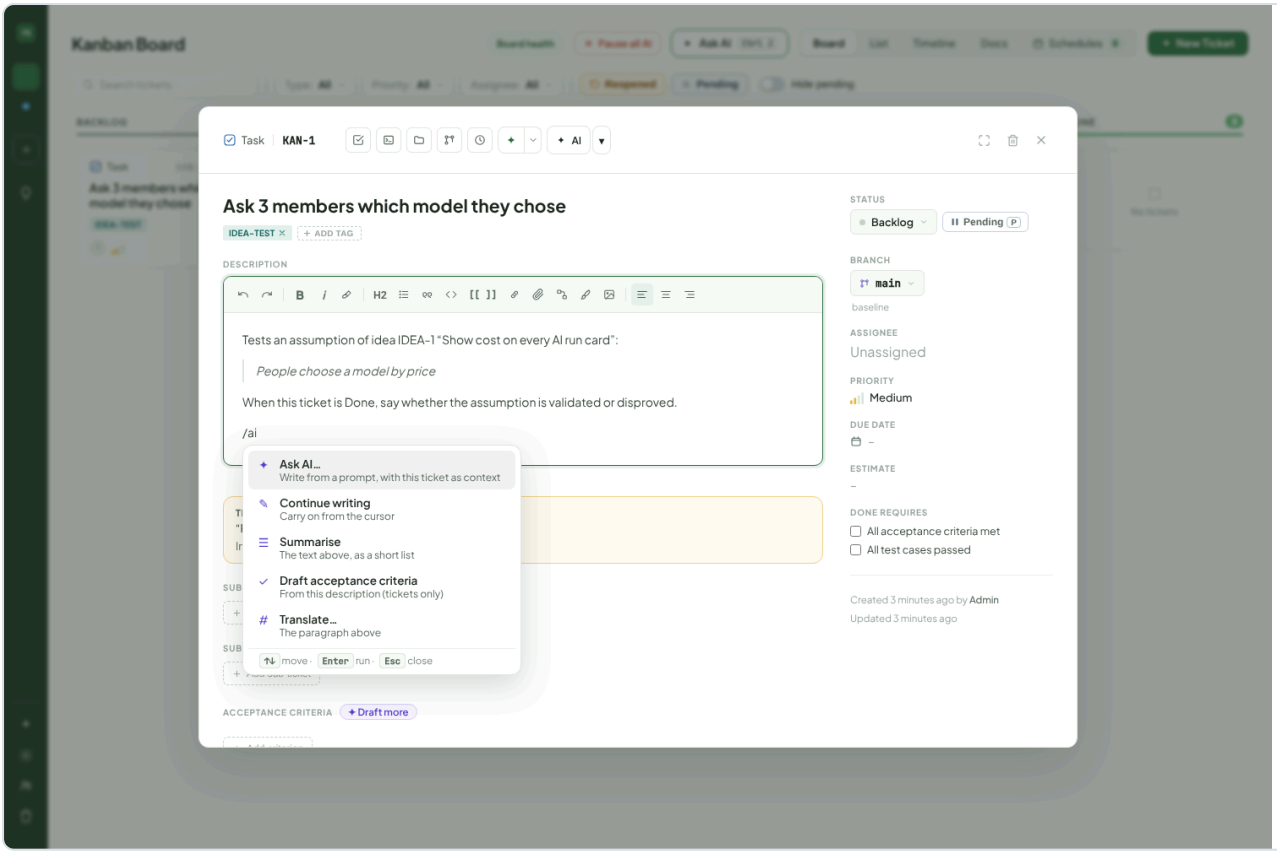
An answer with Post as comment, Copy, what it was based on, cost and feedback.



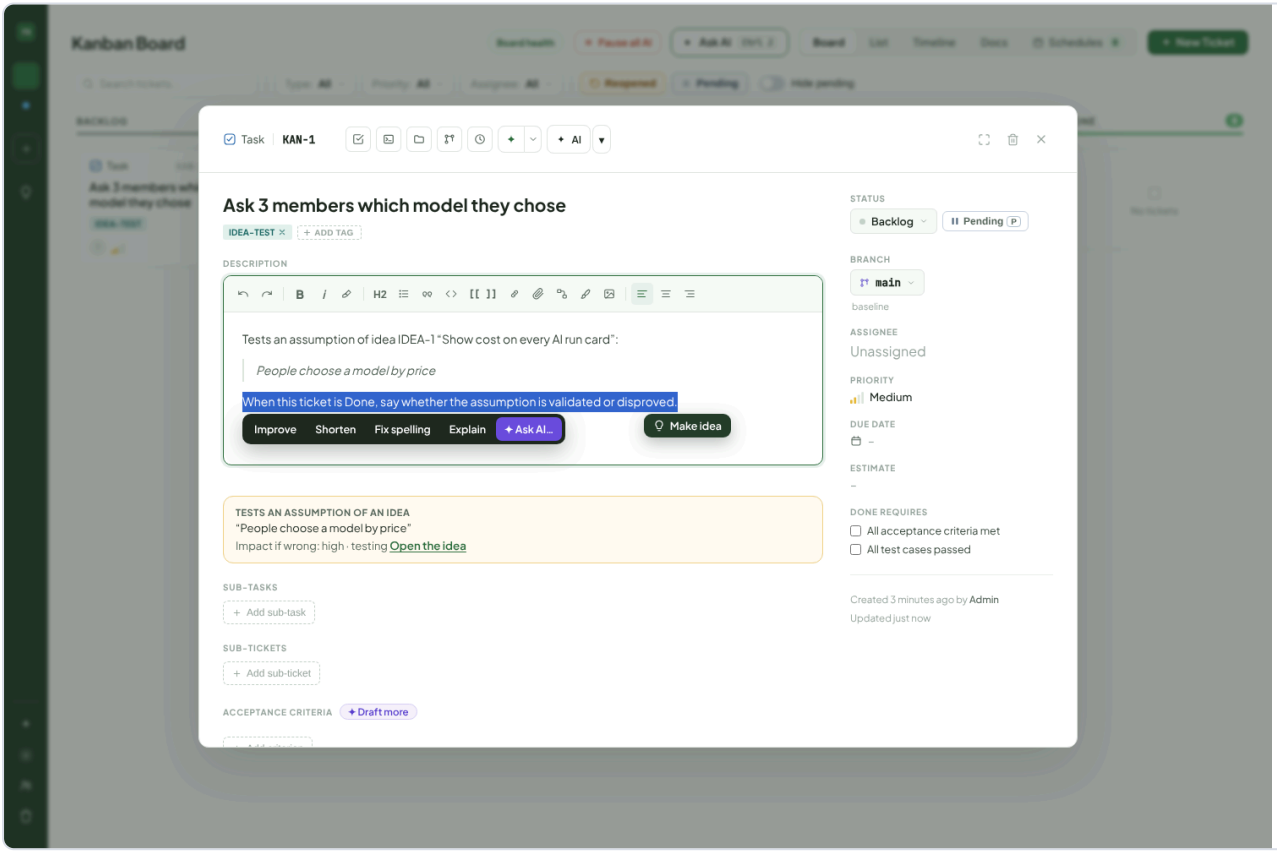
“@” lists people and AI members and says what each AI can do.



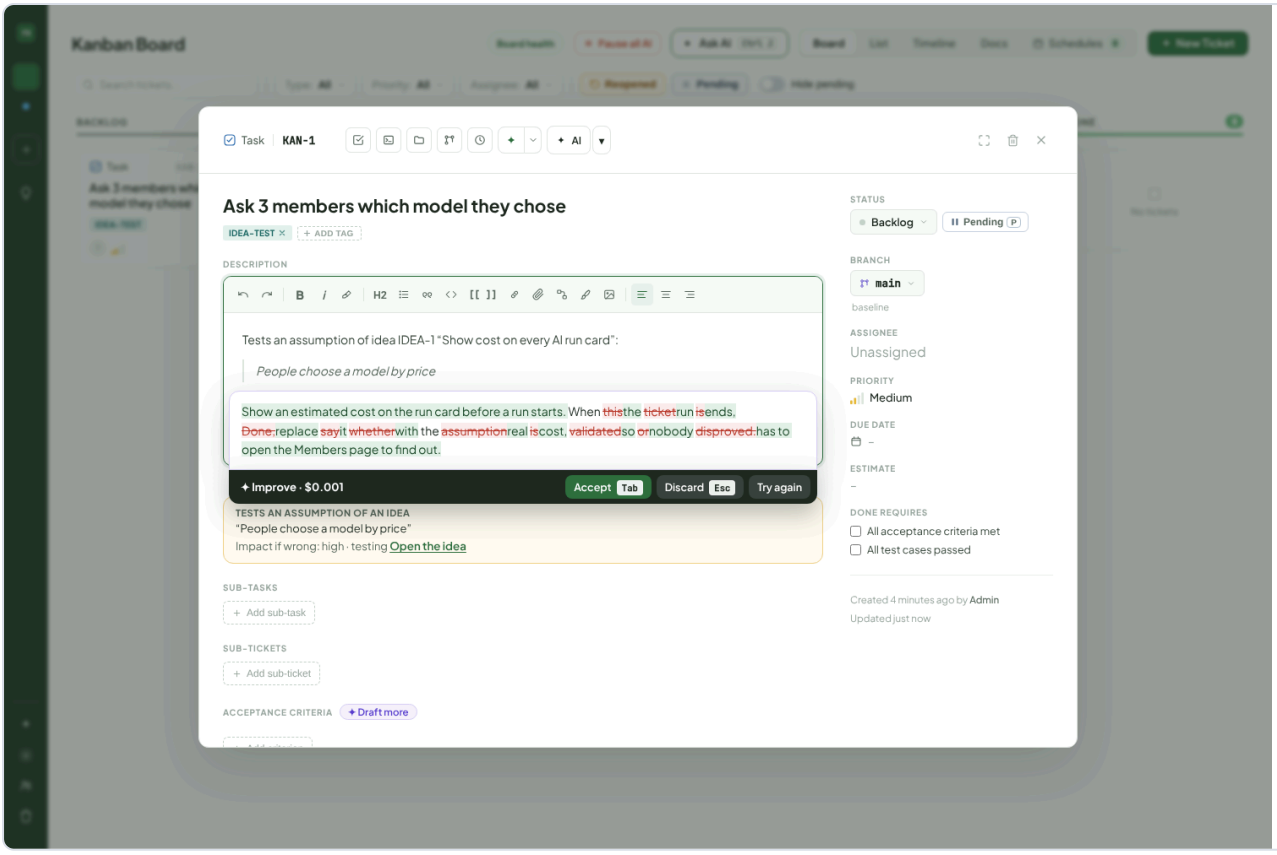
What the mention will do is stated under the box (Ask only is the default), with an estimated cost.



/ai in any editor opens the AI menu at the cursor (here, the ticket description).



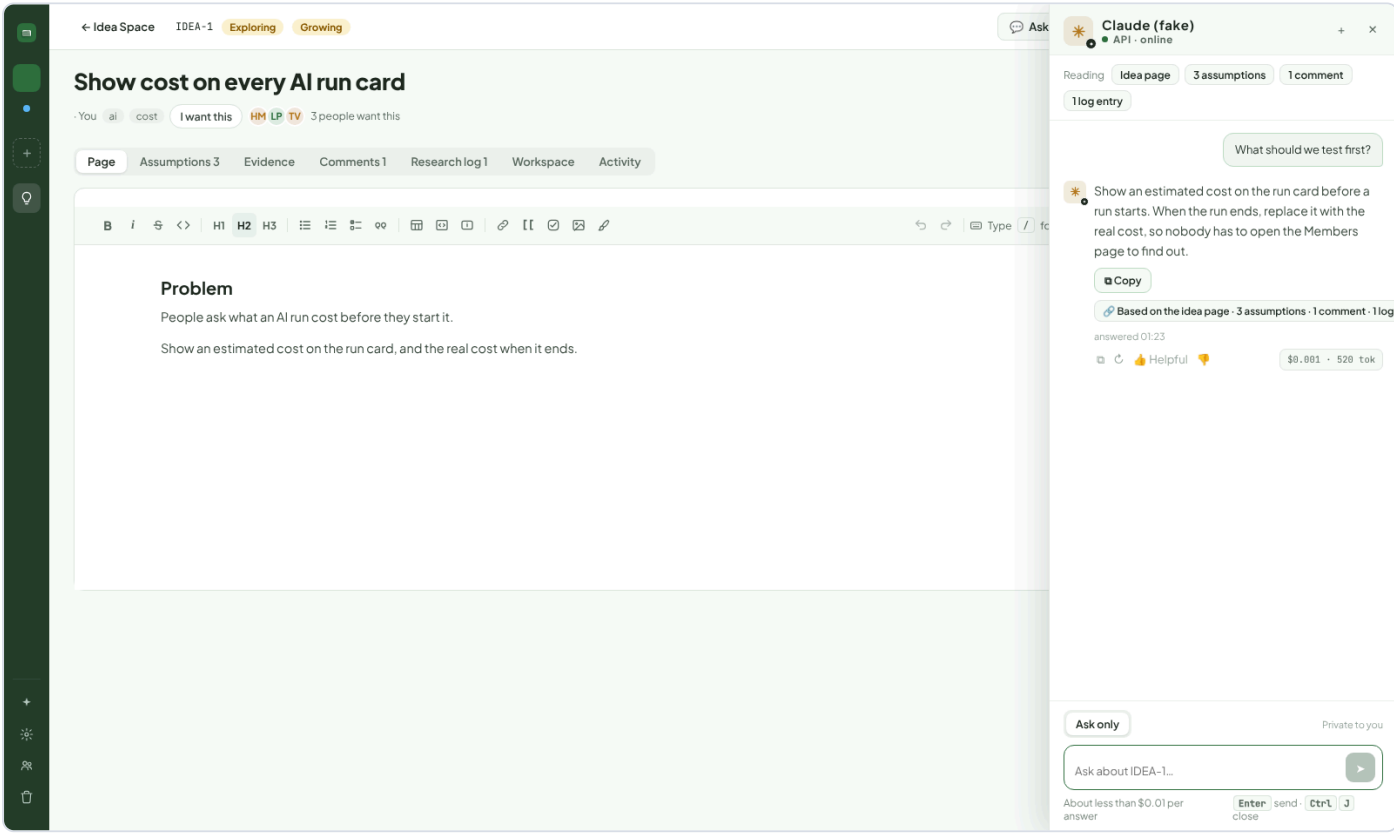
Select text: Improve, Shorten, Fix spelling, Explain, Ask AI...



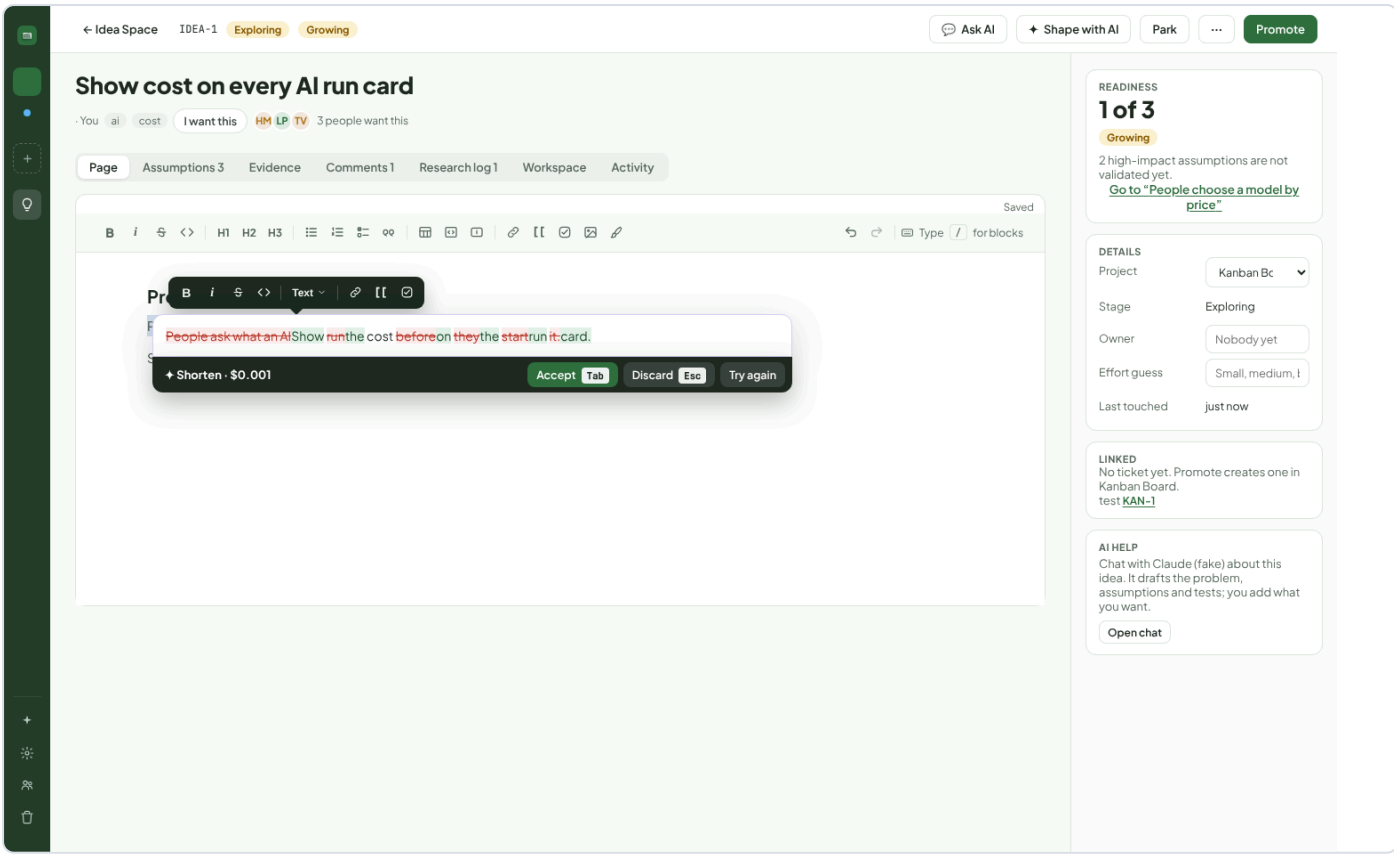
The draft sits over the text with the changes marked. Accept (Tab), Discard (Esc) or Try again.

8. AI on the idea page

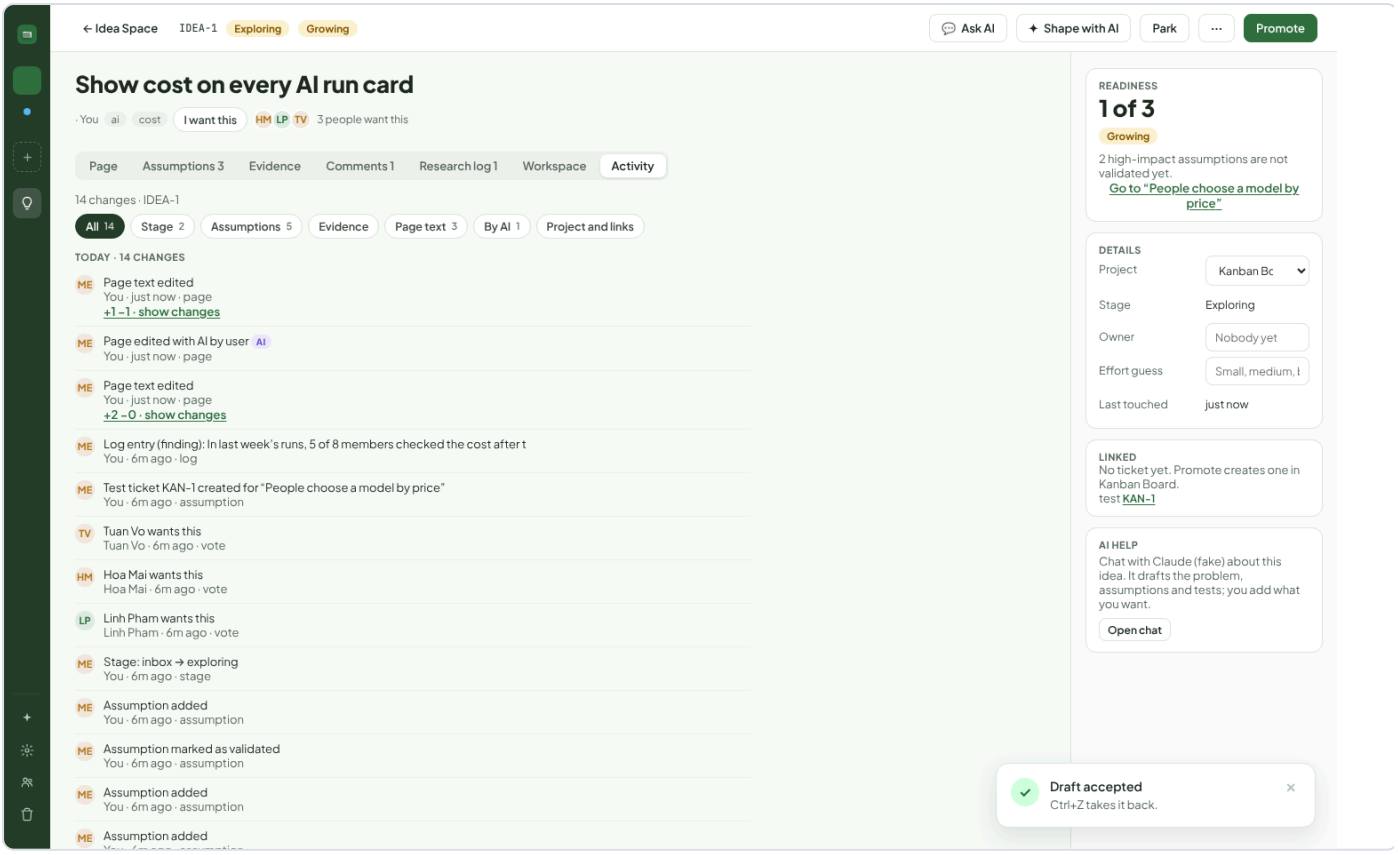
The same editor AI works in the idea page (Docs editor), and the idea has its own chat that reads the page, assumptions, evidence, comments and log. It can propose only new assumptions and page text: never a stage move, merge, archive or promote.



Ask AI on the idea page (“Reading: Idea page, 3 assumptions, 1 comment, 1 log entry”).



Shorten in the idea page.



Accepted drafts are recorded in the idea's Activity ("Page edited with AI", AI badge).

9. What is simplified or not built

Honest list, also written in the specs.

Idea Space

- The matrix's horizontal axis is a simple strength worked out from the status and the evidence, not a scored scale.
- Promote carries evidence into the ticket as an "Attachments from the idea" list, not as separate attachment records.
- Weekly grooming is its own hourly check, not an AI Schedule (those run an AI member on a ticket). Nobody is notified.
- Quick add starts from text, a pasted picture or a sketch; starts from a diagram or a link are not separate buttons.
- "Save to log" from the chat (an AI writing a research entry) is not built.

Sketch

- Lines and arrows only (no curves). One person edits at a time (a conflict card handles the rest). Undo history is not saved. Older versions of a sketch are not kept.

AI where you work

- Sketch AI: older turns are not summarised (the last 14 messages are sent); attachments of earlier turns are named, not re-sent; answers are plain text, not Markdown; no PDF text extraction, no Post as comment; and the Claude Code CLI path with pictures is tested with a faked process, not a real `claude`.
- In the Docs editor, /ai takes two steps (type /ai, then Enter); the other editors open the menu as soon as /ai is typed.
- The idea chat does not read linked Docs, the promoted ticket, the activity trail or files, and cannot start a run. Idea drafts have no conflict check (they are appended, and Undo is guarded).
- Viewers cannot ask the idea chat ("Only members can ask"). Mentions in idea comments do not wake an AI. Docs pages have no activity trail for "edited with AI".
- The idea chat panel sits over the right side of the idea page instead of making room for it.

Verification

- Browser-driven checks covered: the whole Idea Space flow, the AI helpers, Sketch on the idea page, ticket chat, @ plan, /ai, selection bar, drafts and the idea chat. Several of these were exercised by a script, not by long manual use.
- Next page: the one-time conversion of existing ideas (from step 1), produced by running the real migration on a database seeded with ideas of the old model.

Idea Space: the new data model

Issue #203, step 1 · version 3.11.0 · What changes under the Idea board, and what happens to the ideas you already have. Everything below was produced by running the real migration and services on a database seeded with ideas of the old model.

In short. Ideas now have **stages** (Inbox, Exploring, Ready, Building, Parked, Shipped, Archived), a park-until date, an archive reason, a source and a page body. Assumptions are **records** with impact, status, evidence and an optional test ticket. Ideas may belong to **no project**, people can **vote**, and every activity entry has an **author**. The current Idea board is unchanged and keeps working.

1. Existing ideas are converted once

On first start after the update. Eleven ideas of the old model (one per case) and where they land:

IDEA	TODAY	OLD STATUS	BECOMES	DETAIL
IDEA-1	Never edited	`draft`	inbox	
IDEA-2	Edited, 3 assumptions	`draft`	exploring	
IDEA-3	In review	`in_review`	exploring	
IDEA-4	Approved, not promoted	`approved`	ready	
IDEA-5	Promoted, ticket Done	`approved`	shipped	
IDEA-6	Promoted, ticket in progress	`approved`	building	
IDEA-7	Promoted, ticket Won’t do	`approved`	exploring	
IDEA-8	Promoted, ticket deleted	`approved`	ready	ticket link cleared
IDEA-9	Dropped	`dropped`	archived	Imported from the old Idea Space
IDEA-10	Revisit date in the future	`in_review`	parked	park until 2999-01-01
IDEA-11	Revisit date in the past	`in_review`	parked	park until 2020-01-01

2. Nothing is lost

A backup comes first. Before converting, the database is copied next to itself:

```
kanban.before-idea-space-20261029-225122.db
(632 KB)
```

The copy has the old shape (no `stage` column) and all 11 ideas. It is only made when there are ideas to convert.

Old fields stay in place: description, problem statement, microthoughts, ICE and energy are still stored. The new `body` and `details` are built from them:

```
body:
## Problem

The problem

Some text

details:
Energy: hot
ICE: impact 5, effort 2, confidence 4
```

Assumptions become records (same ids and text; “invalidated” is now “disproved”; impact starts at medium):

IDEA	ASSUMPTION	STATUS	IMPACT
IDEA-2	Users care	untested	medium
IDEA-2	It is cheap	validated	medium
IDEA-2	They pay	disproved	medium

Downgrading writes the assumptions back into the old JSON field, so a rollback keeps their latest status.

3. How it behaves now

Quick idea with no project. It lands in the Inbox:

```
id:         IDEA-12
project_id: null
stage:      inbox
source:     manual
```

An assumption record, as the API returns it:

```
{
  "id": "72cbebd6-4121-4cc2-836a-
8ced910cf9e6",
  "text": "People will pay for this",
  "status": "untested",
  "at": "2026-10-29T22:51:23.092071+00:00",
  "state": "testing",
  "impact": "high",
  "test_ticket_id": null,
  "evidence": []
}
```

The current board still works. It reads `status` (old words); the new fields ride along:

```
{
  "status": "invalidated",
  "state": "disproved",
  "impact": "medium"
}
```

Activity has an author:

ENTRY	BY
Idea created	Tuan
Assumption added	user
Assumption marked as testing	Tuan

A Building idea cannot be dropped
Trying to drop IDEA-6 (its ticket is in progress):

```
Not allowed while the ticket is open.
Close or remove the ticket first.
```

Parked ideas wake up
IDEA-11 was parked until 2020-01-01. On the first read it goes back to the Inbox, once:

```
stage: parked → inbox
park_until: None
```

4. What comes next

This is step 1 of the 9 in #203. The REST API and MCP for stage moves, votes, evidence and promote preview (step 2) and the new screens (steps 3 to 9) build on this model and land as their own pull requests.

Backend tests: the full suite passes, including 17 new tests for the migration and the model.